

ENGLISH FOR GROUNDS WORK AND CUSTOMER VISITS

Landscaping and Grounds English

Clear requests. Careful promises.

Phil Stilwell

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Eight lessons. Eleven extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
220 extended-dialogue turns / 11 transfer exchanges
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For grounds workers, landscaping crews, site leads, maintenance coordinators, and customer-facing office staff.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight grounds-work conversations: clarify a booking, respect an unconfirmed property limit, identify a requested plant, explain a weather pause, report standing water, query mulch discrepancies, address missed cleanup, and hand over an unfinished bed review.

01 Confirming the booked grounds work

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A hedge request during a lawn visit | Explain the current work order, acknowledge an additional request, and refer it without inventing a price or appointment.

02 Clarifying access and property limits

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The plan stops at the fence | Separate a work-plan limit from an unverified ownership claim and refer an access request without deciding a legal boundary.

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Which plant needs attention? | Resolve an ambiguous plant reference, describe the requested appearance, and preserve the qualified lead review.

04 Explaining a weather-related change

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A suggested day is not a booking | Explain a work pause, preserve the customer deadline, and distinguish a requested update from a confirmed return visit.

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Standing water beside the east bed | Report a visible condition with its location and time, and respond to a suspected cause without presenting it as confirmed.

06 Checking materials and requested quantities

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Six bags and the wrong label | Compare a delivery with the requested quantity and approved sample, then refer both discrepancies without approving substitution.

07 Responding to finish and cleanup concerns

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Clippings beside the front steps | Acknowledge a specific missed cleanup, identify the included area, and refer correction without expanding the job.

08 Handing over unfinished grounds work

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A clear path and an open bed review | Separate completed work from a deferred review, preserve a callback request, and identify who owns the next arrangement.

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Name the work before promising the result.

A useful grounds-work conversation identifies the exact area, plant, material, or condition under discussion. It separates the agreed job from a new request, a visible observation from a diagnosis, and a proposed visit from a confirmed booking.

Keep the booked scope visible

A request made while the crew is present does not automatically change the work order. Name what is included, what is excluded, and who can review a separate request.

"Today includes front-lawn mowing and path leaf clearance; the rear hedge needs a separate review."

Clarify the plant and the location

The tall one or over there can point to more than one plant or area. Confirm the exact subject and location before a qualified person assesses the requested work.

"You mean the rosemary beside the left flower bed, not the specimen magnolia."

Report what you observed

A wet area does not establish a broken pipe, and a material label does not prove it matches the approved sample. State the observation, location, time, and unanswered question.

"At 09:15 I saw standing water beside the east bed near zone 3; the cause is unknown."

Separate an update from a booking

A weather pause, suggested day, requested callback, and confirmed visit are different stages. Preserve the customer deadline and identify who owns the next communication.

"Thursday is suggested, not booked; I will request a scheduling update by Wednesday noon."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All sites, customers, plants, materials, times, work orders, and decisions in the cases are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not horticultural diagnosis, pruning technique, equipment operation, chemical application, land surveying, or legal boundary advice. Follow actual site controls, training, work orders, local requirements, and qualified-lead decisions. The dialogues do not authorize entering disputed land, pruning a plant, changing irrigation, applying products, substituting materials, or resuming paused work.

A hedge request during a lawn visit

A Read the situation

Explain the current work order, acknowledge an additional request, and refer it without inventing a price or appointment.

At Oak Court, worker Asha explains the booked work to resident Ben. Today includes front-lawn mowing and path leaf clearance. Ben asks the crew to shape the rear hedge as well. Hedge work is excluded from this booking. The office can review a separate request, but no price, date, or approval is confirmed. Asha must preserve the existing work scope while passing on the hedge request accurately, without implying that a quick favor is automatically covered.

PEOPLE / Ben: Resident | Asha: Grounds worker

ACKNOWLEDGE THE REQUEST BEFORE EXPLAINING THE LIMIT

A resident may see the crew on site and assume an additional task is easy to include. Explain the current work order in concrete terms, then identify the separate review route. A clear boundary can remain helpful without criticizing the resident for asking.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is included today?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A Rear-hedge shaping only | B Every outdoor task at Oak Court |
| C Tree removal and irrigation repair | D Front-lawn mowing and path leaf clearance |

2. Which task does Ben add?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A Path leaf clearance already listed | B A confirmed tree removal |
| C Rear-hedge shaping | D Front-lawn mowing already listed |

3. What can Asha offer?

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|---|
| A Immediate free hedge work | B A guaranteed appointment tomorrow |
| C Approval of any extra task | D Office review of a separate request, with no confirmed price or date |

Answers and explanations: [page 85](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

work order

Record specifying the tasks assigned for a particular job.

IN USE check the work order

booked scope

Work included in the agreed booking.

IN USE confirm the booked scope

grounds maintenance

Upkeep of outdoor areas and landscape features.

IN USE discuss grounds maintenance

front lawn

Grassed area at the front of the property.

IN USE identify the front lawn

mowing

Cutting grass as part of the specified lawn task.

IN USE confirm the mowing task

path

Defined walking route through an outdoor area.

IN USE identify the path

leaf clearance

Removal of fallen leaves from the specified area.

IN USE confirm path leaf clearance

rear hedge

Row of shrubs at the back of the site.

IN USE identify the rear hedge

hedge shaping

Work intended to change or maintain a hedge's form.

IN USE request hedge shaping

included task

Activity explicitly covered by the booking.

IN USE name the included tasks

excluded task

Activity outside the current agreed work.

IN USE explain the excluded task

additional request

New work requested beyond the existing arrangement.

IN USE record an additional request

Precision check

The current booking includes front-lawn mowing and path leaf clearance, not rear-hedge shaping. Referring Ben to the office preserves the additional request but does not approve it, price it, or book it for another day.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

separate quotation

Price proposal for work outside the current booking.

IN USE request a separate quotation

site visit

Attendance at a location for defined work or assessment.

IN USE confirm the site visit

crew

Group of workers assigned to the job.

IN USE brief the crew

grounds lead

Person supervising or assessing grounds work.

IN USE consult the grounds lead

office review

Assessment of a request by the coordinating office.

IN USE refer for office review

scope change

Amendment to the agreed work content.

IN USE seek approval for a scope change

task authorization

Permission to carry out the specified work.

IN USE confirm task authorization

service date

Day on which agreed work is scheduled.

IN USE confirm the service date

price estimate

Provisional cost figure for specified work.

IN USE distinguish a price estimate

confirmed booking

Arrangement explicitly agreed and entered through the actual process.

IN USE verify a confirmed booking

request handoff

Transfer of a new request to the responsible person.

IN USE complete a request handoff

completion claim

Statement that assigned work has been finished.

IN USE avoid an unsupported completion claim

Precision check

A task can be outside the booking even when the crew is already on site. Do not infer that it is free, quick, technically appropriate, or authorized. The conversation clarifies scope; it does not establish that the booked tasks have been completed.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE REQUEST

"I understand you would like the rear hedge shaped as well."

STATE THE FIRST TASK

"Front-lawn mowing is included."

NAME THE EXCLUSION

"Rear-hedge work is outside this booking."

EXPLAIN THE REVIEW ROUTE

"The office can review a separate request."

NAME THE BOOKING

"Let me confirm today's work order."

STATE THE SECOND TASK

"Path leaf clearance is included too."

KEEP THE REQUEST SPECIFIC

"You are asking for the rear hedge, not the front lawn."

AVOID A PRICE PROMISE

"I do not have a confirmed price for that work."

As well

Adds a new request and does not prove it belongs to the original booking.

Included versus excluded

Describes the current agreed scope, not all services the business offers.

Separate

Keeps the new hedge request distinct from the existing lawn visit.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A DATE PROMISE

"No service date is confirmed for the hedge."

ASK PERMISSION TO RELAY

"Would you like me to pass the hedge request to the office?"

PRESERVE THE EXISTING WORK

"Today's listed tasks remain mowing and path leaf clearance."

KEEP COMPLETION SEPARATE

"Confirming the scope does not mean the work is finished."

AVOID AN INFORMAL ADDITION

"I cannot add it as a quick favor to today's scope."

SEPARATE REVIEW AND APPROVAL

"A review request is not task authorization."

AVOID A UNIVERSAL REFUSAL

"I am explaining this booking, not ruling out future hedge work."

CLOSE WITH THE NEXT STEP

"I will refer the rear-hedge request with price and timing still open."

Can review

Offers assessment without promising acceptance or availability.

No confirmed date

Avoids turning a possible future service into a scheduled visit.

Quick favor

Informal wording that can obscure authority, cost, and task suitability.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which scope explanation matches the booking?

- A** All grounds work is included because the crew is present.
- B** The rear hedge is automatically included if it looks quick.
- C** Only the hedge is booked today.
- D** Today covers front-lawn mowing and path leaf clearance, not the rear hedge.

2. Which next-step statement is accurate?

- A** I have booked the hedge for tomorrow.
- B** The extra work is free.
- C** Your question authorizes the crew to begin.
- D** I can pass the separate hedge request to the office for review.

3. Which statement overpromises?

- A** The existing scope has not changed.
- B** The hedge will definitely be shaped today at no charge.
- C** No price is confirmed.
- D** The office can review the request.

4. What should remain in the handoff?

- A** All outdoor tasks approved and completed.
- B** Hedge task silently added to the mowing order.
- C** A guessed quotation and appointment.
- D** Rear-hedge shaping requested; separate review needed; price and date unknown.

Answers and explanations: [page 85](#).

A hedge request during a lawn visit

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

rear hedge / scope change / work order / Office review / booked scope / included task / separate quotation / service date / task authorization / request handoff

- 01 **Ben:** Could you shape the rear hedge while you're here? I'd assumed the grounds visit covered that as well as the lawn.
- 02 **Asha:** I can pass that request on. Today's ¹ _____ lists front-lawn mowing and path leaf clearance; the hedge isn't included.
- 03 **Ben:** Oh, I thought it was a general garden visit. You're saying the lawn and the path are the actual tasks on the booking?
- 04 **Asha:** That's the ² _____, yes. Being at Oak Court doesn't mean the crew has approval for every outdoor job.
- 05 **Ben:** Please tell the office it's the hedge at the back. I'm not asking for shaping around the front lawn.
- 06 **Asha:** I'll specify ³ _____ shaping, so the location doesn't get confused with the mowing area. The office can review it separately.
- 07 **Ben:** Would that mean an extra bill? I don't want a request for information to be taken as agreement to a price.
- 08 **Asha:** No ⁴ _____ is confirmed. Asking for a review doesn't commit you to a charge, and I don't have a price to offer.
- 09 **Ben:** All right. Could it happen later this week, or do they need to check the schedule before you can say?
- 10 **Asha:** The ⁵ _____ still needs checking. I can relay your request, but I can't confirm a hedge appointment for this week.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Ben:** Please don't tell the other residents it's booked yet. They'll expect someone to turn up if they hear a definite day.
- 12 **Asha:** ⁶ _____ is the next step. I'll keep it described as a request until there is an actual arrangement.
- 13 **Ben:** What if I only want a quick tidy? Is that different from asking for the hedge to be shaped?
- 14 **Asha:** The wording doesn't replace ⁷ _____. We need the actual work assessed and agreed; I can't add it as a quick favor.
- 15 **Ben:** Then leave it as rear-hedge shaping. I'd rather the office knows what I'm asking for than gets an unclear note.
- 16 **Asha:** I'll make that ⁸ _____ with the location and requested work. Today's mowing and leaf-clearance tasks stay as they are.
- 17 **Ben:** Can you repeat the two tasks before I speak to the residents? I don't want to say the hedge was missed.
- 18 **Asha:** Mowing is the ⁹ _____ for the front lawn; path leaf clearance is also listed. The rear hedge was not part of today's booking.
- 19 **Ben:** Thanks. Please refer the hedge separately. I'll wait for the office to discuss the price and a possible day.
- 20 **Asha:** Yes. No ¹⁰ _____ has been approved in this conversation. I'll send the request with both price and timing still open.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. work order | 2. booked scope | 3. rear hedge | 4. separate quotation | 5. service date | 6. Office review | 7. task authorization | 8. request handoff | 9. included task | 10. scope change

Refer another additional task

F Say it

Elm Court has booked front-lawn mowing and driveway leaf clearance. A resident requests side-hedge shaping. It is excluded from the current booking; the office can review it, with no price or date confirmed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unconfirmed / review / side hedge / mowing

Worker: "The booked lawn task is ¹ _____."

Resident: "The additional request concerns the ² _____."

Worker: "The next step is office ³ _____."

Resident: "The price and date are still ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. mowing | 2. side hedge | 3. review | 4. unconfirmed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the included tasks: front-lawn mowing and path leaf clearance.
2. Repeat Ben's rear-hedge shaping request and the separate office-review route.
3. Read the price and date answers without adding a quotation or appointment.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The plan stops at the fence

A Read the situation

Separate a work-plan limit from an unverified ownership claim and refer an access request without deciding a legal boundary.

At Elm View, customer Rosa asks grounds worker Kai to clear a strip beyond the rear fence. Rosa says the strip is probably part of the property, but ownership is unconfirmed. The current work plan ends at the fence. Kai can report the additional request and uncertainty to the office but cannot determine the property boundary, extend the work area, or assume permission to enter. No ownership conclusion, clearance work beyond the fence, or revised plan is established.

PEOPLE / Rosa: Customer | Kai: Grounds worker

A WORK LIMIT IS NOT A LEGAL BOUNDARY FINDING

A fence can be a clear reference for the booked work without proving ownership of the land beside it. Repeat the customer request respectfully, preserve uncertain wording such as probably, and refer the issue instead of deciding property rights during a maintenance visit.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Where does the current work plan end?

- A** At the rear fence
- B** Beyond the fence to an unknown point
- C** At every area Rosa can see
- D** At a newly approved boundary

2. What is known about the strip's ownership?

- A** Rosa's ownership has been legally established
- B** The neighbor definitely owns it
- C** The worker has completed a survey
- D** It is unconfirmed

3. What can Kai do?

- A** Change the plan without review
- B** Flag the request and uncertainty to the office
- C** Decide the legal boundary
- D** Enter and clear the strip automatically

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

work-plan limit

Endpoint of the area covered by the current assigned work.

IN USE confirm the work-plan limit

rear fence

Fence at the back of the site used as a location reference.

IN USE identify the rear fence

boundary

Line separating areas or property interests, requiring appropriate verification.

IN USE avoid deciding the boundary

property line

Legally relevant limit of a property, not established here.

IN USE request property-line clarification

ownership claim

Statement that land belongs to someone.

IN USE qualify the ownership claim

unconfirmed ownership

Ownership not established by the available information.

IN USE report unconfirmed ownership

land strip

Narrow area of ground.

IN USE identify the land strip

beyond the fence

On the far side of the named fence.

IN USE clarify beyond the fence

within the plan

Inside the assigned scope or area.

IN USE stay within the plan

adjacent land

Land next to the current site or work area.

IN USE distinguish adjacent land

access permission

Authorization to enter a specific area.

IN USE verify access permission

entry request

Request to go into an area for work.

IN USE refer an entry request

Precision check

The work-plan limit is the rear fence. That fact does not prove the legal property line or ownership of the strip beyond it. Rosa says probably; the uncertainty must remain explicit in the office referral.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

clearance request

Request to remove vegetation or debris from a specified area.

IN USE define the clearance request

site plan

Document or drawing identifying site areas and planned work.

IN USE consult the site plan

survey

Professional measurement or assessment of land boundaries or features.

IN USE distinguish a survey from a visual guess

fence alignment

Position of the fence relative to the surrounding site.

IN USE describe the fence alignment

assumption

Belief accepted without adequate verification.

IN USE avoid an ownership assumption

qualified statement

Wording that preserves uncertainty or a stated limit.

IN USE retain a qualified statement

scope extension

Proposed expansion of the assigned work area or tasks.

IN USE request a scope extension

authorized area

Area for which relevant work permission is established.

IN USE confirm the authorized area

boundary clarification

Process of resolving uncertainty about the relevant property limit.

IN USE seek boundary clarification

office referral

Transfer of a question to the coordinating office.

IN USE make an office referral

site restriction

Limit governing access or work at the location.

IN USE respect the site restriction

revised plan

Updated work arrangement after the appropriate review and approval.

IN USE await a revised plan

Precision check

Access permission, property ownership, and the booked work area are separate questions. The dialogue supplies no legal determination or permission to enter and clear beyond the fence. Refer the request through the actual process before any proposed scope extension.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE REQUESTED AREA

"You mean the strip beyond the rear fence?"

STATE THE CURRENT LIMIT

"Our work plan ends at the fence."

SEPARATE PLAN AND TITLE

"The work-plan limit does not determine the property line."

AVOID AN ACCESS ASSUMPTION

"I cannot assume permission to enter beyond the fence."

CONFIRM THE TASK

"You would like that strip cleared."

PRESERVE UNCERTAINTY

"You said it is probably yours; ownership is not confirmed."

AVOID A LEGAL CONCLUSION

"I cannot decide who owns that strip."

OFFER REFERRAL

"I can flag the request to the office."

Probably

Signals uncertainty and must not be rewritten as definite ownership.

Beyond versus within

Distinguishes the requested strip from the current planned area.

Ends at

Defines the work-plan limit without establishing a legal property line.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP THE ISSUE SPECIFIC

"The question concerns the strip beyond the rear fence."

NAME THE REQUIRED REVIEW

"The office needs to review the request and the access question."

AVOID CLAIMING A SURVEY

"We have not established the boundary through this conversation."

KEEP THE OUTCOME OPEN

"No revised plan is confirmed yet."

AVOID A VISUAL SHORTCUT

"The fence position alone does not settle ownership here."

PRESERVE THE EXISTING PLAN

"No extension of the work area is approved."

ATTRIBUTE THE STATEMENT

"The customer believes the strip may belong to the property."

CLOSE WITH THE NEXT STEP

"I will pass on the clearance request with ownership and permission still unresolved."

Believes

Attributes the claim rather than endorsing it as verified fact.

Permission versus ownership

These are related but separate questions requiring the appropriate process.

Referred versus approved

Passing a request to the office does not extend the work area.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which report preserves the uncertainty?

- A** Kai has established the legal boundary.
- B** Rosa believes the strip may be theirs; ownership is unconfirmed.
- C** Rosa definitely owns the strip because she said probably.
- D** The neighbor definitely owns it because it is beyond the fence.

2. What does the rear fence establish in this scenario?

- A** Permission to work on both sides.
- B** An automatically revised clearance area.
- C** The endpoint of the current work plan.
- D** The definitive legal property line.

3. Which action is within Kai's stated role?

- A** Perform a boundary survey without qualification.
- B** Clear beyond the fence while ownership is unknown.
- C** Treat the extra strip as already authorized.
- D** Refer the request and access uncertainty to the office.

4. Which statement wrongly combines separate questions?

- A** The current plan ends at the fence.
- B** No revised plan is confirmed.
- C** If the customer believes it is theirs, entry and clearance are automatically approved.
- D** Work scope and ownership both need clarification.

Answers and explanations: [page 87](#).

The plan stops at the fence

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

revised plan / fence alignment / scope extension / additional request / work-plan limit / beyond the fence / qualified statement / land strip / office referral / boundary clarification

- 01 **Rosa:** Could you clear the strip beyond the rear fence? I think it's probably ours, but I'm not certain.
- 02 **Kai:** You mean the ¹ _____ beyond the fence, not the ground on this side? I want to make sure I pass on the correct area.
- 03 **Rosa:** Yes, that narrow strip on the far side. The fence looks as though it's inside the edge, but I haven't confirmed it.
- 04 **Kai:** Thank you for clarifying. The current ² _____ is the rear fence. That tells me where this job ends, but it does not establish the legal boundary.
- 05 **Rosa:** I'd hoped you could include it while the crew was here. Does asking now change the work area?
- 06 **Kai:** It creates an ³ _____ to refer, not an approved extension. I cannot decide the ownership question or assume permission to enter beyond the fence.
- 07 **Rosa:** Please keep probably in the note. I don't want it recorded as though I've established ownership.
- 08 **Kai:** I will keep the ⁴ _____ accurate: you believe the strip may belong to the property, but ownership has not been confirmed.
- 09 **Rosa:** Does the fence position help? The planting continues past it, but that may not tell us much.
- 10 **Kai:** The ⁵ _____ alone does not settle ownership here. A planting pattern is not enough for me to make a property-line determination either.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Rosa:** All right. I'd rather check than ask you to clear land that turns out not to be ours.
- 12 **Kai:** I can make an ⁶ _____. I will identify the strip, the clearance request, and the uncertainty about ownership and access.
- 13 **Rosa:** Please refer it. I'm asking about clearance, not saying you've agreed to do it today.
- 14 **Kai:** Correct. No ⁷ _____ has been approved. The current plan still ends at the fence while the additional request is reviewed.
- 15 **Rosa:** If I find any ownership information, should I send it to the office for their review?
- 16 **Kai:** Yes. The relevant ⁸ _____ and access review need the proper process. This conversation is not a survey or a legal decision about the strip.
- 17 **Rosa:** Could you read back the exact area? I don't mean everything behind the property.
- 18 **Kai:** You request clearance of the strip ⁹ _____. Ownership is unconfirmed, and no permission or extension of the current work area has been established here.
- 19 **Rosa:** That's the request. Please keep the uncertainty in the referral, and I'll wait for the office.
- 20 **Kai:** I will pass it on. A ¹⁰ _____ is not confirmed yet. The existing work limit remains the fence, with the extra request and its uncertainties clearly recorded.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. land strip | 2. work-plan limit | 3. additional request | 4. qualified statement | 5. fence alignment | 6. office referral | 7. scope extension | 8. boundary clarification | 9. beyond the fence | 10. revised plan

Refer another uncertain area request

F Say it

A work plan ends at a side gate. A customer asks for clearance beyond it and says the area may belong to the property. Ownership and access are unconfirmed; the worker can refer the request to the office.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

gate / unconfirmed / review / may

Worker: "The current plan ends at the side ¹ _____."

Customer: "The area ² _____ belong to the property."

Worker: "Ownership remains ³ _____."

Customer: "The next step is office ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. gate | 2. may | 3. unconfirmed | 4. review

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the fence as the work-plan limit, not a verified property line.
2. Repeat Rosa's probably or may wording when attributing her ownership belief.
3. Read the office referral without treating it as permission to enter the strip.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Which plant needs attention?

A Read the situation

Resolve an ambiguous plant reference, describe the requested appearance, and preserve the qualified lead review.

At the entrance to Maple House, customer Nina asks worker Tomas to tidy the tall one. Two plants stand nearby: rosemary beside the left flower bed and a specimen magnolia. Nina means the rosemary, not the magnolia. She wants a neater appearance but has not specified a suitable pruning method or extent. A qualified lead must assess whether and how any pruning fits the job. Identifying the plant does not authorize the worker to cut it.

PEOPLE / Nina: Customer | Tomas: Grounds worker

A DESCRIPTION IS NOT A TECHNICAL INSTRUCTION

Customers often describe the visual result they want rather than a horticultural method. Repeat the plant and location, clarify the appearance goal, and pass the request to the qualified lead without turning casual words into an agreed cutting instruction.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which plant does Nina mean?

- A** An unidentified tree at the rear
- B** The rosemary beside the left flower bed
- C** The specimen magnolia
- D** Both plants without distinction

2. What result does she request?

- A** A neater appearance
- B** A confirmed removal
- C** A diagnosed disease treatment
- D** A specified cutting depth

3. What remains necessary?

- A** Immediate cutting because the plant is identified
- B** Approval inferred from a pointing gesture
- C** A promise that any method will work
- D** Qualified lead review of whether and how pruning fits the job

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

plant identification

Establishing which plant a person is referring to.

IN USE confirm plant identification

rosemary

Named plant in the customer's request.

IN USE identify the rosemary

specimen plant

Individual plant grown as a distinct feature.

IN USE identify the specimen plant

magnolia

Named plant excluded from this particular request.

IN USE distinguish the magnolia

flower bed

Defined area containing ornamental plants.

IN USE locate the left flower bed

entrance planting

Plants positioned near the property entrance.

IN USE describe the entrance planting

appearance goal

Visual result the customer wants.

IN USE clarify the appearance goal

tidy up

Informal request to make something look neater.

IN USE clarify what tidy up means

pruning

Selective removal of plant parts for a defined purpose.

IN USE refer a pruning request

plant form

Overall shape and structure of a plant.

IN USE describe the plant form

growth habit

Characteristic way a plant grows.

IN USE assess the growth habit

canopy

Above-ground spread of a woody plant's branches and foliage.

IN USE describe the canopy

Precision check

The rosemary is identified, while the magnolia is excluded from this request. Nina wants a neater appearance. Neither that preference nor the clearer plant reference determines a suitable pruning method, pruning extent, or permission to start cutting.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

foliage

Leaves collectively.

IN USE refer to the foliage

branch

Woody growth extending from a stem or trunk.

IN USE identify the branch

stem

Supporting axis bearing a plant's leaves or growth.

IN USE identify the stem

plant health

Condition of the living plant.

IN USE assess plant health

qualified assessment

Review by someone with the relevant competence.

IN USE request a qualified assessment

pruning extent

Amount and reach of proposed pruning.

IN USE clarify the pruning extent

proposed method

Suggested way to carry out a task.

IN USE review the proposed method

reference point

Fixed feature used to clarify a location.

IN USE use a reference point

cultivar

Named cultivated selection within a plant group, such as lavender Hidcote.

IN USE confirm the cultivar name

customer preference

Result favored by the customer.

IN USE record the customer preference

botanical name

Scientific plant name identifying genus and species, with cultivar where relevant.

IN USE read the full botanical name

cutting authorization

Permission to perform specified cutting work.

IN USE confirm cutting authorization

Precision check

Tidy up is useful as the beginning of a conversation, but it is not a precise work instruction. The lead must assess the request and its fit with the job. Avoid converting an informal appearance goal into removal, treatment, or immediate pruning.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

CLARIFY THE REFERENCE

"Which plant do you mean by the tall one?"

USE THE LOCATION

"Is it the rosemary beside the left flower bed?"

CLARIFY THE RESULT

"What would you like to look neater?"

AVOID AN INVENTED DIAGNOSIS

"I have not assessed the plant's health."

OFFER THE TWO CANDIDATES

"Do you mean the rosemary or the specimen magnolia?"

CONFIRM THE EXCLUSION

"You are not asking us to work on the magnolia."

PRESERVE THE WORDING

"I will record a neater appearance as your goal."

SEPARATE IDENTIFICATION AND PERMISSION

"We have identified the plant, but pruning is not yet authorized."

The tall one

An ambiguous reference when more than one plant could fit the description.

Beside

Gives a location relative to a visible reference point.

Not the magnolia

Explicitly excludes the other candidate from the request.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

REFER THE METHOD

"The qualified lead needs to assess how to approach it."

CHECK THE JOB FIT

"The lead also needs to check whether it fits this job."

READ BACK THE REQUEST

"Rosemary beside the left flower bed, with a neater appearance requested."

EXPLAIN THE NEXT STEP

"I will pass the specific request to the lead."

REFER THE EXTENT

"The amount of pruning is still to be assessed."

AVOID PROMISING REMOVAL

"I am not recording a removal request."

KEEP THE OTHER PLANT SEPARATE

"The magnolia is outside this request."

CLOSE WITHOUT APPROVAL

"No cutting decision has been made in this conversation."

Neater

Describes an appearance preference without specifying a method.

Whether and how

Preserves both job suitability and the appropriate approach for review.

Identified versus authorized

Knowing the subject does not establish permission to perform the task.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which clarification resolves the ambiguity?

- A** Do you mean the rosemary beside the left flower bed, not the magnolia?
- B** Do you mean both entrance plants need the same work?
- C** Do you want the magnolia beside the left bed tidied?
- D** Do you mean the rosemary should be removed?

2. Which record preserves Nina's request?

- A** Both plants diagnosed as unhealthy.
- B** Immediate heavy pruning authorized.
- C** Rosemary beside the left flower bed; neater appearance requested; lead review needed.
- D** Magnolia removal approved.

3. Which statement goes beyond the facts?

- A** The pruning method remains to be assessed.
- B** The rosemary definitely needs a specific amount cut off today.
- C** The customer means the rosemary.
- D** The magnolia is excluded.

4. What can Tomas confirm now?

- A** The plant's health diagnosis
- B** That pruning is included and approved
- C** The plant and the requested visual goal
- D** The best pruning method

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

Which plant needs attention?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

appearance goal / plant identification / customer preference / Cutting authorization / reference point / Scope fit / left-hand bed / pruning extent / proposed method / qualified assessment

- 01 **Nina:** Could you tidy the tall one by the entrance? I mean the one beside that bed; it looks a bit untidy.
- 02 **Tomas:** For ¹ _____, do you mean the rosemary beside the left flower bed, or the specimen magnolia? Both are near the entrance.
- 03 **Nina:** The rosemary, please. Not the magnolia. I can see why the tall one wasn't a very useful description with both here.
- 04 **Tomas:** I'll use the left bed as the ² _____ and name the rosemary in the note. That should keep the two plants separate.
- 05 **Nina:** I don't know the gardening term for what I want. Neater is probably the best way I can describe it.
- 06 **Tomas:** I can record that ³ _____ without choosing a cutting method. The lead needs to assess what is suitable for this plant and this job.
- 07 **Nina:** That's fine. I don't want someone to take off a large amount just because I said tidy it up.
- 08 **Tomas:** The ⁴ _____ hasn't been decided. We've identified the plant, but not how much, if anything, should be removed.
- 09 **Nina:** And please don't put removal in the note. I want to keep the rosemary; I'm asking about how it looks.
- 10 **Tomas:** I'll preserve that ⁵ _____. Neater appearance, not removal, and no request to work on the magnolia.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Nina:** Does the lead also need to check whether this is part of our booking? I wasn't sure if I could add it while you're here.
- 12 **Tomas:** Yes, ⁶ _____ still needs review. An appearance request doesn't automatically add pruning to the work order.
- 13 **Nina:** Could the lead explain what they're proposing before anything is cut? I'd like to know what the result would mean.
- 14 **Tomas:** The ⁷ _____ needs that assessment first. I'm not recommending a technique or promising a particular result from this conversation.
- 15 **Nina:** Please read the location back for me. The entrance has several plants, and I don't want the wrong one included.
- 16 **Tomas:** Rosemary beside the ⁸ _____ at the entrance; neater appearance requested; magnolia excluded. The qualified lead reviews suitability and whether it belongs to this job.
- 17 **Nina:** Yes, that's the one. I'm agreeing that you've understood my request, not agreeing to an amount of cutting today.
- 18 **Tomas:** ⁹ _____ isn't established by that clarification. I'll keep the request separate from any later decision to proceed.
- 19 **Nina:** Thank you. Send that to the lead, please. I'll wait to hear the assessment rather than choose a pruning amount myself.
- 20 **Tomas:** I'll refer it for a ¹⁰ _____, with the plant and your appearance goal clear. No pruning has been agreed or reported complete.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. plant identification | 2. reference point | 3. appearance goal | 4. pruning extent | 5. customer preference | 6. Scope fit | 7. proposed method | 8. left-hand bed | 9. Cutting authorization | 10. qualified assessment

Read back the plant request

F Say it

Complete this exchange using the clarified plant, the excluded plant, the appearance goal, and the unresolved review. Do not add a pruning amount or approval.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

assess / rosemary / magnolia / neater

Worker: "You mean the ¹ _____ beside the left flower bed."

Customer: "The ² _____ is not part of my request."

Worker: "Your goal is a ³ _____ appearance."

Customer: "The qualified lead still needs to ⁴ _____ it."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. rosemary | 2. magnolia | 3. neater | 4. assess

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read rosemary beside the left flower bed, then explicitly exclude the magnolia.
2. Repeat neater appearance without replacing it with a pruning amount or removal.
3. Read the lead-review lines, keeping plant identification separate from cutting authorization.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A suggested day is not a booking

A Read the situation

Explain a work pause, preserve the customer deadline, and distinguish a requested update from a confirmed return visit.

At Cedar Court, lead Imani has paused planned outdoor work because of site conditions after rain. Customer Joel has an event on Friday. The office has suggested Thursday as a possible return day, but crew availability is unconfirmed. Imani can relay the event and request a scheduling update by Wednesday noon. Neither the Thursday visit nor completion before the event is promised. The customer needs an accurate status and a clear next communication point.

PEOPLE / Joel: Customer | Imani: Grounds lead

GIVE USEFUL CERTAINTY AT THE RIGHT LEVEL

When a customer faces a deadline, a possible day can easily sound like a promise. State the known pause, the suggested day, the unresolved availability, and the requested update separately. Acknowledge the event without guaranteeing work that is not scheduled.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Why is the work paused?

- | | |
|---|-------------------------------------|
| A A confirmed cancellation of all future service | B A completed job |
| C A customer refusal to pay | D Site conditions after rain |

2. What is the status of Thursday?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A A date the customer has rejected | B Suggested, with crew availability unconfirmed |
| C A confirmed return visit | D A guaranteed completion date |

3. What communication can Imani request?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A Automatic work resumption now | B A confirmed Thursday appointment |
| C A scheduling update by Wednesday noon | D Guaranteed completion before Friday |

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

weather pause

Temporary stop associated with weather-related conditions.

IN USE explain a weather pause

site conditions

Physical circumstances at the work location.

IN USE assess site conditions

rainfall

Rain received at a location.

IN USE refer to recent rainfall

ground condition

State of the surface or soil at the site.

IN USE review the ground condition

waterlogged

Saturated with water beyond normal drainage.

IN USE describe a waterlogged area

planned work

Tasks intended for the scheduled visit.

IN USE identify the planned work

resumption

Starting work again after a pause.

IN USE confirm authorization for resumption

tentative date

Proposed day that is not yet confirmed.

IN USE state a tentative date

crew availability

Whether the required workers are available.

IN USE confirm crew availability

scheduling update

New information about arrangements for work.

IN USE request a scheduling update

return visit

Later attendance to continue or review work.

IN USE discuss a return visit

event deadline

Time constraint created by a planned event.

IN USE relay the event deadline

Precision check

Thursday is a suggested return day, not a confirmed booking. Wednesday noon is the requested scheduling-update time, not a work-completion deadline. Friday is the customer event. Keep these three time references separate when summarizing the conversation.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

completion date

Day on which work is expected or agreed to finish.

IN USE avoid an unsupported completion date

weather dependency

Reliance on suitable weather-related circumstances.

IN USE explain a weather dependency

provisional suggestion

Idea offered before arrangements are confirmed.

IN USE label a provisional suggestion

customer constraint

Limitation affecting what the customer needs.

IN USE record a customer constraint

office coordinator

Person arranging visits and communication.

IN USE contact the office coordinator

confirmation status

Whether an arrangement is agreed or remains open.

IN USE state the confirmation status

update target

Requested time for the next communication.

IN USE specify the update target

service interruption

Break in planned service delivery.

IN USE explain a service interruption

revised schedule

Changed arrangement for when work occurs.

IN USE confirm a revised schedule

outstanding check

Matter still requiring verification.

IN USE name the outstanding check

deadline pressure

Urgency arising from a time limit.

IN USE acknowledge deadline pressure

work status

Current stage of the assigned work.

IN USE report the work status

Precision check

The lead has paused work because of site conditions after rain. The book does not prescribe when those conditions become suitable. Neither customer urgency nor a calendar suggestion authorizes resumption or establishes that the work will be complete before the event.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE PAUSE

"The planned outdoor work is paused because of the site conditions after rain."

STATE THE SUGGESTION

"The office has suggested Thursday."

CORRECT AN ASSUMPTION

"Thursday is a possibility, not a booked return visit."

RELAY THE CONSTRAINT

"I will pass the Friday event detail to the office."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE IMPACT

"I understand the Friday event makes the timing important."

PRESERVE UNCERTAINTY

"Crew availability has not been confirmed."

SEPARATE THE DEADLINE

"Friday is your event date, not a completion promise from us."

REQUEST THE UPDATE

"I will request a scheduling update by Wednesday noon."

Paused

Describes the present work status without claiming permanent cancellation.

Suggested

Marks a proposed date rather than an agreed appointment.

By Wednesday noon

Gives the requested communication deadline, not a service deadline.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

DISTINGUISH THE TWO TIMES

"Wednesday noon concerns the update, not the work itself."

KEEP THE PAUSE INTACT

"The suggestion does not authorize work to resume now."

AVOID INVENTING A CAUSE

"I am reporting the site conditions, not diagnosing a drainage fault."

PRESERVE CUSTOMER PLANNING

"Please do not treat Thursday as a confirmed arrangement yet."

AVOID A GUARANTEE

"I cannot guarantee completion before the event."

NAME THE UNRESOLVED CHECK

"Availability still needs to be checked."

REPEAT THE CURRENT STATUS

"Work is paused and no return date is confirmed."

CLOSE WITH THE HANDOFF

"I will relay your event deadline and the requested update time."

Before Friday

Refers to the desired timing relative to the customer event.

Unconfirmed

Leaves availability open without implying that it is definitely unavailable.

Request versus promise

Asking for an update does not prove the office has accepted that deadline.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which explanation preserves all three dates?

- A** Work is guaranteed Wednesday and the event is Thursday.
- B** Friday is the confirmed return day.
- C** Wednesday noon is the guaranteed completion time.
- D** Thursday is suggested; an update is requested by Wednesday noon; the event is Friday.

2. Which statement should be corrected?

- A** Thursday is definitely booked and everything will be finished before Friday.
- B** Crew availability remains unconfirmed.
- C** Work has been paused.
- D** The customer has a Friday event.

3. What should Imani send the office?

- A** An invented resumption authorization
- B** A confirmed Thursday appointment
- C** The Friday event detail and a request for a scheduling update by Wednesday noon
- D** A report that the customer accepted completed work

4. What does unconfirmed availability mean?

- A** The work is already complete
- B** The crew arrangement still needs verification
- C** The crew is definitely free
- D** The crew is definitely unavailable

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

A suggested day is not a booking

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

customer constraint / event deadline / scheduling update / work status / tentative date / office coordinator / service interruption / confirmation status / outstanding check / resumption

- 01 **Joel:** I heard Thursday mentioned. We've got an event on Friday; can I tell the organizer the work will be finished?
- 02 **Imani:** Not yet. The current ¹ _____ is paused because of the site conditions after rain. I understand why you need a reliable answer before your event.
- 03 **Joel:** Thursday sounded definite when I heard it. Is a crew assigned, or was it only a possible day?
- 04 **Imani:** It is a ² _____. The office suggested Thursday, but crew availability has not been confirmed. Please do not treat that suggestion as a booked visit.
- 05 **Joel:** I'm not asking you to ignore the site conditions. I just need to know what arrangements I can rely on.
- 06 **Imani:** I will relay that ³ _____ clearly. Friday is your event date; it is not a completion commitment that we have made, and I should keep those separate.
- 07 **Joel:** Can we ask for an update before Wednesday lunchtime? Friday morning would be too late for my planning.
- 08 **Imani:** I can request a ⁴ _____ by Wednesday noon. That is a request for the next communication, not a promise that the work will happen then.
- 09 **Joel:** So Wednesday noon is the update request, and Thursday is still only the possible return day.
- 10 **Imani:** Exactly. The ⁵ _____ of Thursday remains open. The office still needs to check availability before a return arrangement can be confirmed.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Joel:** Please include the Friday event in the message. That's why I need the scheduling answer.
- 12 **Imani:** Yes. I will include your ⁶ _____ and the requested Wednesday-noon update together. The message will say the timing matters for your event, without guaranteeing a result.
- 13 **Joel:** Has the pause actually been lifted, or is Thursday just a calendar suggestion at this stage?
- 14 **Imani:** The suggestion does not establish ⁷ _____. The pause remains the current status, and I will not present a calendar suggestion as permission to restart the work.
- 15 **Joel:** I'd prefer an honest unresolved update to a date that sounds certain and then falls through.
- 16 **Imani:** I will make the ⁸ _____ explicit. Crew availability is unconfirmed, and no return date or completion date has been agreed in this conversation.
- 17 **Joel:** Please request Wednesday noon and flag Friday. I won't tell the organizer Thursday is booked.
- 18 **Imani:** I will pass both details to the ⁹ _____. Requesting the update does not mean the office has already accepted the deadline, so I will describe it accurately.
- 19 **Joel:** Thanks. Work paused, Thursday suggested, update requested by Wednesday noon, event Friday. I'll keep those separate.
- 20 **Imani:** That is the correct summary of the ¹⁰ _____. I will relay it without adding a booking or a promise that everything will be finished before your event.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. work status | 2. tentative date | 3. customer constraint | 4. scheduling update | 5. confirmation status | 6. event deadline | 7. resumption | 8. outstanding check | 9. office coordinator | 10. service interruption

Separate three time references

F Say it

Complete the customer update. Keep the pause, the suggested Thursday visit, the requested Wednesday-noon update, and the Friday event in their correct roles.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

suggested / paused / noon / Friday

Lead: "The work remains ¹ _____ because of the site conditions."

Customer: "Thursday is ² _____, not confirmed."

Lead: "I will request an update by Wednesday ³ _____."

Customer: "My event is on ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. paused | 2. suggested | 3. noon | 4. Friday

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the three time references: Wednesday-noon update, suggested Thursday, Friday event.
2. Repeat requested and suggested with emphasis; neither means confirmed.
3. Read the current pause without implying the calendar suggestion authorizes resumption.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Standing water beside the east bed

A Read the situation

Report a visible condition with its location and time, and respond to a suspected cause without presenting it as confirmed.

05

At 09:15, worker Leila sees standing water beside the east bed near irrigation zone 3 at Birch Court. Customer Evan asks whether a pipe is broken. The cause is unknown, and no irrigation-system check has occurred. Leila can report the observation and refer it to grounds lead Marco, who can arrange review. She must not turn the location near a zone into proof that the zone, a pipe, or another component has failed.

PEOPLE / Evan: Customer | Leila: Grounds worker

ANSWER THE CONCERN WITHOUT ADOPTING THE DIAGNOSIS

A customer may offer a possible explanation in the form of a question. Acknowledge the concern, then separate what you saw from what has not been checked. Specific location and time details make the referral useful without requiring a guessed technical answer.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What did Leila observe?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A A confirmed broken pipe | B A completed irrigation repair |
| C A failed controller diagnosis | D Standing water beside the east bed at 09:15 |

2. What has not occurred?

- | | |
|---|--------------------------------------|
| A Identification of the east bed | B An irrigation-system check |
| C A customer question | D A visible water observation |

3. Who can arrange review?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A Grounds lead Marco | B A worker who has already diagnosed the pipe |
| C A confirmed repair crew arriving now | D The customer through an already booked repair |

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

standing water

Water collected on a surface rather than visibly draining away.

IN USE report standing water

pooling

Accumulation of water in a particular area.

IN USE describe observed pooling

irrigation

Artificial supply of water to plants or land.

IN USE discuss the irrigation system

irrigation zone

Defined area or circuit served as part of an irrigation system.

IN USE identify irrigation zone 3

sprinkler head

Outlet that distributes irrigation water.

IN USE identify a sprinkler head

irrigation line

Pipe or tubing carrying water within an irrigation system.

IN USE refer to an irrigation line

valve

Component controlling flow through a line.

IN USE identify a valve

controller

Device managing system operation settings or timing.

IN USE refer to the controller

drainage

Movement or removal of water from an area.

IN USE describe a drainage concern

runoff

Water flowing over a surface.

IN USE report visible runoff

saturation

Condition of material holding a high amount of water.

IN USE describe visible saturation

east bed

Planting area on the east side of the identified site.

IN USE locate the east bed

Precision check

Standing water is an observation. A broken pipe is a possible explanation raised by Evan, not a finding. Near zone 3 identifies the location; it does not prove that zone 3 or any particular irrigation component is faulty.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

observation time

When the reported condition was seen.

IN USE include the observation time

visible condition

State that can be directly seen.

IN USE report the visible condition

suspected cause

Possible explanation that has not been established.

IN USE distinguish a suspected cause

confirmed fault

Problem established through appropriate checking.

IN USE avoid claiming a confirmed fault

system check

Examination of the relevant system.

IN USE request a system check

leak

Escape of water from a system or container.

IN USE refer a possible leak concern

pipework

Pipes collectively within a system.

IN USE refer to the pipework

inspection request

Request for examination of a condition or system.

IN USE pass an inspection request

precipitation rate

Irrigation application depth per unit of time, commonly millimeters or inches per hour.

IN USE compare precipitation rates

review owner

Person responsible for arranging or carrying out a review.

IN USE name the review owner

diagnosis

Identification of the cause or nature of a problem.

IN USE distinguish observation from diagnosis

distribution uniformity

Measure of how evenly irrigation is applied across sampled positions.

IN USE assess distribution uniformity

Precision check

The useful report includes what was seen, where, when, and what has not been checked. Marco can arrange review. Do not add a leak diagnosis, repair plan, visit time, or claim that someone has already tested the system.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

NAME THE OBSERVATION

"I saw standing water beside the east bed."

GIVE THE TIME

"I noticed it at 09:15."

LOCATE THE AREA

"It is near irrigation zone 3."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE CONCERN

"I understand why you are asking about a pipe."

SEPARATE POSSIBILITY FROM FINDING

"A broken pipe has not been confirmed."

STATE THE LIMIT

"I do not know the cause."

KEEP THE CHECK STATUS CLEAR

"No irrigation-system check has taken place."

AVOID A LOCATION INFERENCE

"Being near zone 3 does not identify the faulty component."

Observed

Claims only that the worker saw the condition.

Near

Locates the observation without establishing a causal connection.

Could be

Introduces a possibility and should not be repeated later as a confirmed cause.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

REFER THE OBSERVATION

"I will report what I saw to Marco."

PRESERVE THE CUSTOMER QUESTION

"I will include your question about a possible pipe problem."

DISTINGUISH REPORTING AND TESTING

"Passing the report does not mean the system has been tested."

READ BACK THE DETAILS

"East bed, near zone 3, observed at 09:15."

NAME THE REVIEW ROUTE

"The grounds lead can arrange a review."

AVOID A REPAIR PROMISE

"No repair or visit time is confirmed."

USE NEUTRAL WORDING

"Standing water observed; cause unknown."

CLOSE WITH THE NEXT STEP

"Marco can review the report and arrange the appropriate follow-up."

No check yet

Preserves the actual evidence limit at the time of the conversation.

Arrange review

Describes a next step, not a completed inspection or repair.

Cause unknown

Gives a precise limit rather than a vague reassurance.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which report is supported?

- A** Marco has completed a repair.
- B** Standing water beside the east bed near zone 3 at 09:15; cause unknown.
- C** Zone 3 has a confirmed broken pipe.
- D** The controller failed at 09:15.

2. How should Leila answer the pipe question?

- A** The repair is already booked.
- B** I cannot confirm that; no system check has occurred.
- C** Yes, because the patch is beside the irrigation zone.
- D** No, because recent rain already explains the water.

3. Which detail must not be silently changed?

- A** Near zone 3 must not become a confirmed fault in zone 3.
- B** The east bed remains the location.
- C** The observation time remains 09:15.
- D** Marco remains the grounds lead.

4. Which next step is accurate?

- A** Announce that the system passed inspection.
- B** Promise a same-day repair.
- C** Tell the customer the pipe has been replaced.
- D** Refer the observation to Marco, who can arrange review.

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

Standing water beside the east bed

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

observation time / visible condition / standing water / suspected cause / irrigation zone / site location / inspection request / confirmed fault / system check / review owner

- 01 **Evan:** There's water beside the east bed. Could a pipe be broken? I'm worried it might be more than a wet patch.
- 02 **Leila:** I noticed the ¹ _____ at nine fifteen. I can report exactly where it is, but I haven't established what caused it.
- 03 **Evan:** Is that near zone 3 on the irrigation plan? I remember seeing that number beside this part of the garden.
- 04 **Leila:** Yes, near ² _____ 3. That gives us a location reference; it doesn't prove that the zone or a particular component caused the water.
- 05 **Evan:** Has anyone checked the system? I don't want to tell the office it's a pipe problem if they've already found something else.
- 06 **Leila:** No ³ _____ has happened yet. I'll include that in the report so it isn't mistaken for an inspection result.
- 07 **Evan:** Please include the time you saw it. The patch may look different by the time someone comes to review it.
- 08 **Leila:** I'll record the ⁴ _____ as zero nine fifteen, with the east bed and nearby zone number. It isn't a confirmed fault-start time.
- 09 **Evan:** I'm asking about a pipe, not saying I know one's broken. That was just the first explanation that occurred to me.
- 10 **Leila:** I'll keep it as a ⁵ _____ raised in your question. The observation itself is standing water, with the cause still unknown.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Evan:** Who should get the report? I'd like someone to take the next step rather than have it passed around without an owner.
- 12 **Leila:** Marco, the grounds lead, is the ⁶ _____ for this referral. He can arrange the appropriate review of what you've raised.
- 13 **Evan:** So we're asking for it to be checked. That doesn't mean there's already a repair crew booked to come here?
- 14 **Leila:** Correct. We're reporting a ⁷ _____ and requesting review. No repair or attendance time has been confirmed.
- 15 **Evan:** Could the note actually say cause unknown? I don't want a message about a possible leak shortened to leak confirmed.
- 16 **Leila:** Yes. I won't record a ⁸ _____. I'll retain cause unknown and no system check, alongside what I actually saw.
- 17 **Evan:** Read the location back once, please. There are several beds, and I want the lead sent the right information.
- 18 **Leila:** The ⁹ _____ is beside the east bed, near zone 3, observed at zero nine fifteen. Your question concerns a possible pipe problem.
- 19 **Evan:** That's right. Please pass it to Marco with the time and the fact that nothing has been checked yet.
- 20 **Leila:** I'll send that ¹⁰ _____. Marco can arrange review, and any later finding must come from the actual check, not our guess about the cause.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. standing water | 2. irrigation zone | 3. system check | 4. observation time | 5. suspected cause | 6. review owner | 7. visible condition | 8. confirmed fault | 9. site location | 10. inspection request

Pass on an observation accurately

F Say it

Complete the report to Marco. Keep the visible condition, time, location, and unknown cause distinct. Do not turn the customer question into a diagnosis.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

09:15 / 3 / unknown / water

Worker: "I observed standing ¹ _____ beside the east bed."

Worker: "The observation time was ² _____."

Worker: "The area is near zone ³ _____."

Worker: "The cause is ⁴ _____; no system check has occurred."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. water | 2. 09:15 | 3. 3 | 4. unknown

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read standing water, east bed, near zone 3, and 09:15.
2. Repeat the possible-pipe question as a question, not a confirmed diagnosis.
3. Read Marco's role and leave inspection findings and visit timing unresolved.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Six bags and the wrong label

A Read the situation

Compare a delivery with the requested quantity and approved sample, then refer both discrepancies without approving substitution.

At Cedar Lane, a front-bed job lists eight bags of dark mulch. Customer Mira approved a dark sample. Worker Dev counts six delivered bags, whose label says natural brown. The delivered material has not been approved as a substitute. Dev cannot promise that six bags will cover the beds or that the labeled color matches the sample. The office will query the supplier about both the two-bag shortage and the apparent color discrepancy.

PEOPLE / Mira: Customer | Dev: Grounds worker

06

SEPARATE TWO DISCREPANCIES INSTEAD OF AVERAGING THEM AWAY

A delivery can have more than one mismatch. State the count and the description separately, and keep each compared with its correct reference. A customer question about making do does not establish coverage, color acceptance, or authority to substitute the material.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What quantity is listed and what arrived?

A Six listed; eight delivered; two extra

C Two listed and six delivered

B Eight listed and eight delivered

D Eight bags listed; six delivered; two short

2. Which description raises a second question?

A A confirmed identical color

C A customer-approved replacement already recorded

B No label and no sample

D Natural brown on the delivered label versus the approved dark sample

3. What is the next step?

A Automatic acceptance of a substitute

C A claim that the customer changed the order

B A guarantee that six bags cover the beds

D Office query to the supplier about both discrepancies

Answers and explanations: page 95.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

mulch

Material placed over a soil surface for a specified landscape purpose.

IN USE confirm the mulch specification

bag count

Number of bags counted in a delivery.

IN USE verify the bag count

requested quantity

Amount stated in the job or order.

IN USE compare the requested quantity

delivered quantity

Amount actually received.

IN USE record the delivered quantity

shortfall

Amount by which the delivered total is below the required total.

IN USE report a two-bag shortfall

material specification

Stated requirements for a material.

IN USE check the material specification

approved sample

Example accepted as a reference for the requested product.

IN USE compare the approved sample

color description

Words identifying the intended or labeled color.

IN USE check the color description

natural brown

Color description on the delivered bags in this case.

IN USE record the natural-brown label

dark mulch

Requested mulch description in the job.

IN USE confirm the dark-mulch request

product label

Information attached to or printed on the material packaging.

IN USE read the product label

supplier query

Question sent to the business providing the material.

IN USE raise a supplier query

Precision check

Eight requested minus six delivered leaves two bags short. Separately, natural brown appears on the delivered label while the job and approved sample specify dark mulch. The quantity calculation does not resolve whether the delivered material matches or is acceptable.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

quantity discrepancy

Difference between expected and actual amounts.

IN USE report a quantity discrepancy

description discrepancy

Difference between the requested and delivered descriptions.

IN USE report a description discrepancy

substitute material

Product proposed instead of the specified material.

IN USE seek approval for substitute material

substitution approval

Agreement to use an alternative product.

IN USE confirm substitution approval

coverage

Area that a quantity of material can cover under relevant conditions.

IN USE avoid an unsupported coverage promise

material takeoff

Calculation of required material quantities from dimensions and specifications.

IN USE check the material takeoff

delivery record

Document or entry describing a delivery.

IN USE check the delivery record

order reference

Identifier connecting a query to the relevant order.

IN USE include the order reference

replacement request

Request for an appropriate replacement product.

IN USE discuss a replacement request

net area

Area requiring material after stated exclusions have been subtracted.

IN USE calculate the net area

acceptance

Agreement that delivered material meets the relevant requirement.

IN USE distinguish receipt from acceptance

material match

Agreement between a supplied material and its specified reference.

IN USE verify the material match

Precision check

The case does not supply bed dimensions, application requirements, or a verified coverage calculation. Do not promise that six bags will be enough. Neither physical delivery nor a customer question about using it establishes approval of substitute material.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE ORDER QUANTITY

"The job lists eight bags."

CALCULATE THE DIFFERENCE

"That leaves a two-bag shortfall."

READ THE DELIVERED DESCRIPTION

"The delivered label says natural brown."

KEEP THE ISSUES SEPARATE

"We have a quantity question and a material-description question."

STATE THE DELIVERY COUNT

"I have counted six delivered bags."

NAME THE REQUESTED MATERIAL

"The specified material is dark mulch."

USE THE SAMPLE REFERENCE

"Your approved sample was dark."

AVOID A MATCH CLAIM

"I cannot confirm that this matches the approved sample."

06

Short by two

Expresses the difference between eight expected and six received.

Label says

Reports packaging information without claiming a verified visual or technical match.

Approved sample

Refers to the customer's accepted reference, not any later substitute.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A COVERAGE CLAIM

"I cannot promise that six bags will cover the beds."

REFER BOTH DISCREPANCIES

"The office will query the supplier about both points."

AVOID ASSIGNING BLAME

"The cause of the discrepancy has not been established."

READ BACK THE COMPARISON

"Eight requested, six delivered, and natural brown on the label."

PRESERVE APPROVAL STATUS

"No substitution has been approved."

AVOID CHANGING THE ORDER

"I am not recording six bags as the requested quantity."

KEEP TIMING OPEN

"No replacement delivery time is confirmed."

CLOSE WITH THE REVIEW ROUTE

"The supplier query needs to resolve quantity and material before acceptance is assumed."

Enough

A coverage claim requiring more information than the bag count alone.

Both

Keeps quantity and material description in the supplier query.

Delivered versus accepted

Receiving material does not establish that it satisfies the order.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

06

1. Which calculation is correct?

- A** Two short means only two were ordered.
- B** Eight requested minus six delivered equals two bags short.
- C** Six minus eight means two bags extra.
- D** Eight requested means eight delivered.

2. Which statement preserves the color issue?

- A** The customer approved any available color.
- B** The label has already been corrected.
- C** The label says natural brown, while the approved sample was dark.
- D** Natural brown is confirmed identical to the approved sample.

3. How should Dev answer whether six bags are enough?

- A** I cannot promise coverage from the information we have.
- B** Six is enough if each bag is spread more thinly.
- C** Six should cover it because the label color is similar.
- D** Six covers three quarters of the area regardless of bag volume.

4. What belongs in the supplier query?

- A** Only a request to approve the delivery automatically
- B** An invented replacement arrival time
- C** A claim that the customer changed the sample
- D** Both the two-bag shortage and the material-description discrepancy

Answers and explanations: [page 95](#).

Six bags and the wrong label

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

acceptance / approved sample / requested quantity / Substitution approval / bag count / supplier query / quantity discrepancy / product label / coverage / replacement request

- 01 **Mira:** We expected eight bags of dark mulch. I'm counting fewer, and these labels say natural brown. Can you check?
- 02 **Dev:** I have checked the ¹ _____ and found six. The job lists eight bags, so the delivery is two bags short before we address the description.
- 03 **Mira:** My approved sample was dark. Does natural brown mean someone changed the specification, or don't we know yet?
- 04 **Dev:** I cannot say that. The ² _____ says natural brown, and the requested material is dark mulch. No approved change has been established.
- 05 **Mira:** If the color is acceptable, could six bags cover the beds? Or are we short of what the job needs?
- 06 **Dev:** I cannot promise ³ _____ from the count alone. We need to keep the missing quantity separate from the question of whether this material matches what you approved.
- 07 **Mira:** Please keep eight as the ordered quantity. Six is what arrived, not what I asked for.
- 08 **Dev:** I will preserve the ⁴ _____ as eight. The record will show six delivered and two short, not a revised order for six bags.
- 09 **Mira:** Could you include the actual sample in the query? The color word alone isn't the reference I approved.
- 10 **Dev:** I will refer to the ⁵ _____ as well as the job description. I am not confirming a match between that sample and the delivered bags.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Mira:** What happens next? I don't want the crew using it on the assumption that it's close enough.
- 12 **Dev:** The office will raise a ⁶ _____ about both points. The query will include the two-bag shortage and the difference between the label and your approved reference.
- 13 **Mira:** Are we ordering a replacement now, or just asking the supplier to explain the delivery?
- 14 **Dev:** No ⁷ _____ has been confirmed as an order. I also do not have a replacement delivery time to give you now.
- 15 **Mira:** All right. I'm asking about options, not accepting a smaller quantity or a different material.
- 16 **Dev:** I will. ⁸ _____ is still absent. Your question about making do will not be recorded as acceptance of a different material or a smaller quantity.
- 17 **Mira:** Can you summarize both issues? I don't want the missing two bags to hide the color question.
- 18 **Dev:** The ⁹ _____ is eight requested against six delivered. Separately, the delivered label says natural brown while your approved sample and the job request are dark.
- 19 **Mira:** Please send both points. We still don't know whether the material matches or whether six bags could cover the beds.
- 20 **Dev:** I will keep ¹⁰ _____ open while the office queries the supplier. The count, the material description, and any proposed resolution will remain separate in the message.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. bag count | 2. product label | 3. coverage | 4. requested quantity | 5. approved sample | 6. supplier query | 7. replacement request | 8. Substitution approval | 9. quantity discrepancy | 10. acceptance

Report two delivery discrepancies

F Say it

Complete the office handoff. Include the original quantity, the delivered count, the resulting shortage, and the unapproved material description.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

two / eight / brown / six

Worker: "The job requires ¹ _____ bags of dark mulch."

Worker: "We received ² _____ bags."

Worker: "We are ³ _____ bags short."

Worker: "The label says natural ⁴ _____; substitution is not approved."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. eight | 2. six | 3. two | 4. brown

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read eight requested, six delivered, and two bags short.
2. Compare natural brown on the label with the approved dark sample.
3. Read the supplier query with both discrepancies and no coverage or substitution promise.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Clippings beside the front steps

A Read the situation

Acknowledge a specific missed cleanup, identify the included area, and refer correction without expanding the job.

After a front-lawn visit at Rowan Court, customer Hazel says the path cleanup was incomplete. Worker Amir can see clippings beside the front steps, which are within the listed cleanup area. The rear patio is excluded from the booking. The lead can organize the missed front cleanup, but no wider task or exact return time is agreed. Amir must acknowledge the visible concern without denying it, declaring it resolved, or adding the rear patio to the job.

PEOPLE / Hazel: Customer | Amir: Grounds worker

07

ACKNOWLEDGE THE SPECIFIC PROBLEM BEFORE DISCUSSING SCOPE

A customer who reports incomplete work needs evidence that the concern has been heard. Name the visible missed area first. Then separate the correction of an included task from a new request, keeping the explanation calm and specific rather than defensive.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What can Amir see?

- A A confirmed damaged patio
- C Clippings beside the front steps

- B A completed return visit
- D A fully cleared front path

2. Which area is included?

- A Every outdoor surface
- C The front steps within the listed cleanup area

- B An unspecified neighboring property
- D The excluded rear patio

3. What can the lead organize?

- A The missed front cleanup
- C A completed correction already recorded

- B An automatically expanded whole-property cleanup
- D A guaranteed return at an invented time

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

clippings

Small pieces of plant material left after cutting.

IN USE report remaining clippings

cleanup area

Location included in the agreed clearing task.

IN USE identify the cleanup area

front steps

Steps at the front entrance of the property.

IN USE locate the front steps

rear patio

Paved outdoor area at the back of the property.

IN USE distinguish the rear patio

missed cleanup

Included clearing work left incomplete.

IN USE acknowledge missed cleanup

finish concern

Customer concern about the final condition of work.

IN USE record a finish concern

visible residue

Material remaining that can be seen.

IN USE describe visible residue

incomplete task

Assigned work that has not been fully carried out.

IN USE identify the incomplete task

corrective visit

Later attendance intended to address a problem.

IN USE discuss a corrective visit

remedial work

Work intended to correct an identified issue.

IN USE arrange remedial work

included area

Location covered by the booking.

IN USE confirm the included area

excluded area

Location outside the agreed booking.

IN USE explain the excluded area

07

Precision check

The visible clippings support Hazel regarding the missed front cleanup. They do not establish a wider problem across every area of the property. The front steps are included; the rear patio is excluded. Correcting the included task does not automatically expand the booking.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

customer complaint

Expression of dissatisfaction with a service or result.

IN USE acknowledge a customer complaint

service recovery

Action to address a problem in delivered service.

IN USE discuss service recovery

completion status

Whether the relevant work is finished.

IN USE correct the completion status

scope boundary

Limit of the work or area agreed.

IN USE preserve the scope boundary

follow-up arrangement

Plan for the next contact or attendance.

IN USE confirm a follow-up arrangement

return time

Time of a later attendance.

IN USE avoid inventing a return time

cleanup standard

Agreed expectation for the condition after clearing.

IN USE refer to the cleanup standard

workmanship

Quality of work performed.

IN USE discuss a workmanship concern

correction request

Request to put an identified problem right.

IN USE pass a correction request

additional area

Location beyond the existing task area.

IN USE identify an additional area

observation record

Note of a condition directly seen.

IN USE make an observation record

resolution

Outcome that addresses the reported issue.

IN USE verify the resolution

07

Precision check

The lead can organize the missed front cleanup, but organization is not completion. No precise return time is supplied. Avoid marking the complaint resolved before the correction is verified, or promising rear-patio work as part of the existing arrangement.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE CONCERN

"I can see the clippings beside the front steps."

STATE THE MISSED WORK

"That part of the cleanup is incomplete."

REFER CORRECTION

"The lead can organize the missed front cleanup."

AVOID A TIMING PROMISE

"I do not have a confirmed return time."

CONFIRM THE INCLUDED AREA

"Those steps are within the listed cleanup area."

AVOID A DENIAL

"I will not describe the area as fully cleared."

KEEP COMPLETION ACCURATE

"The correction has not yet been completed."

SEPARATE THE REAR AREA

"The rear patio is outside this booking."

I can see

Acknowledges direct evidence without requiring the customer to repeat the complaint.

That part

Limits the finding to the identified incomplete area.

Within scope

Connects the correction to the agreed booking.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

PRESERVE THE SCOPE

"The correction concerns the included front area."

AVOID GENERALIZING

"I am reporting this visible area, not claiming every task was missed."

EXPLAIN THE NEXT STEP

"I will pass the correction request to the lead."

READ BACK THE HANDOFF

"Missed front cleanup, within scope, with follow-up still to be arranged."

ACKNOWLEDGE ANOTHER REQUEST

"Rear-patio cleanup would be a separate request."

KEEP THE RECORD SPECIFIC

"Clippings remain beside the front steps."

AVOID PREMATURE CLOSURE

"I will not mark the concern resolved now."

CLOSE RESPECTFULLY

"Thank you for showing me the exact area."

Separate request

Keeps the excluded patio distinct from correction of the front cleanup.

Organize versus complete

Arranging a response is not evidence that the work is finished.

Resolved

Should describe an established outcome, not merely receipt of a complaint.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which opening best acknowledges the evidence?

- A** Everything was completed because the crew left.
- B** You must be referring to the excluded patio.
- C** There cannot be any clippings.
- D** I can see clippings beside the front steps, within the cleanup area.

07

2. Which scope statement is accurate?

- A** The lead can organize missed front cleanup; the rear patio remains excluded.
- B** A complaint automatically includes the rear patio.
- C** No front cleanup was ever booked.
- D** Every outdoor area is now approved.

3. Which status should not be recorded yet?

- A** Missed front cleanup reported
- B** Clippings visible beside the steps
- C** Return time unconfirmed
- D** Resolved and fully corrected

4. What belongs in the correction request?

- A** A statement that the rear patio was damaged
- B** The exact front-step location, visible clippings, included scope, and pending follow-up
- C** An invented all-property cleaning promise
- D** A guaranteed return time not supplied

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

Clippings beside the front steps

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

correction request / completion status / clippings / return time / rear patio / missed cleanup / Resolution / observation record / follow-up arrangement / scope boundary

07

- 01 **Hazel:** The cleanup beside the front steps hasn't been finished. There are still clippings there, and that area was included, wasn't it?
- 02 **Amir:** Yes, it was. I can see the ¹ _____ beside the steps. You're right to point out that the included area hasn't been fully cleared.
- 03 **Hazel:** Thank you for looking. I was worried I'd just be told the crew had left, so everything must be complete.
- 04 **Amir:** The ² _____ needs to match what's here, not simply whether the visit has ended. I'll record this part as incomplete.
- 05 **Hazel:** Can the lead arrange for that bit to be put right? I'm asking for the work we already booked.
- 06 **Amir:** Yes, the lead can organize the ³ _____ at the front. I'll give the exact location rather than a general message about the garden.
- 07 **Hazel:** While they're dealing with it, could they clear the rear patio too? It would help to have both areas done.
- 08 **Amir:** The ⁴ _____ is outside this booking. I can pass that on as a separate request, but it's not included in the front correction.
- 09 **Hazel:** That's fair. Please don't let the patio question distract from the missed work beside the steps. That's the concern I'm reporting.
- 10 **Amir:** I'll preserve the ⁵ _____: front cleanup to be corrected, patio request separate. Asking about the patio doesn't cancel the front concern.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Hazel:** Do you have a time for someone to return? I can plan around it once it's actually arranged.
- 12 **Amir:** I don't have a confirmed ⁶ _____ yet. I'll refer the correction to the lead without promising an appointment that isn't booked.
- 13 **Hazel:** Please mention that you saw the clippings yourself. That may make the note clearer than just saying I complained.
- 14 **Amir:** The ⁷ _____ will say clippings beside the front steps, inside the listed cleanup area. That's the part I've directly seen.
- 15 **Hazel:** I'm not saying nothing was done. The issue I'm showing you is this unfinished part of the path cleanup.
- 16 **Amir:** I'll keep the ⁸ _____ specific to that area. It won't say the whole visit failed or that the rear patio was included.
- 17 **Hazel:** Thanks. Please don't close the complaint just because we've spoken. I need the missed cleanup dealt with, not only acknowledged.
- 18 **Amir:** ⁹ _____ still needs to follow the actual correction. I'll leave it open rather than mark it resolved when I pass on the message.
- 19 **Hazel:** Good. The front steps are the first issue. The patio can be discussed separately, with its own scope and timing.
- 20 **Amir:** I'll ask the lead for the ¹⁰ _____ for the missed front cleanup. The exact return time remains unconfirmed until it's arranged.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. clippings | 2. completion status | 3. missed cleanup | 4. rear patio | 5. scope boundary | 6. return time | 7. observation record | 8. correction request | 9. Resolution | 10. follow-up arrangement

Acknowledge and refer the missed area

F Say it

Complete the exchange about the visible front cleanup problem. Keep the included correction, excluded patio, and unresolved timing separate.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unconfirmed / excluded / included / steps

Worker: "Clippings remain beside the front ¹ _____."

Customer: "That area was ² _____ in the booking."

Worker: "The rear patio remains ³ _____."

Worker: "The lead can organize correction; the return time is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. steps | 2. included | 3. excluded | 4. unconfirmed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the visible clippings and the included front-step location.
2. Repeat the correction request separately from the excluded rear-patio request.
3. Read the closing follow-up without marking the complaint resolved or inventing a time.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A clear path and an open bed review

A Read the situation

Separate completed work from a deferred review, preserve a callback request, and identify who owns the next arrangement.

At Pine Court, worker Rosa hands the visit over to office coordinator Ava. Front-path leaves are cleared. The lead deferred the rear-bed review; no planting or diagnosis was done there. The customer asks for a callback about the rear bed before Friday. Ava owns scheduling, but no visit date is booked. Rosa must distinguish the completed front-path task, the deferred review, the requested communication deadline, and the unresolved appointment.

08

PEOPLE / Rosa: Grounds worker | Ava: Office coordinator

HAND OVER SEPARATE STATUSES, NOT A SINGLE OVERALL LABEL

A visit may contain both completed work and an unresolved request. A short handoff still needs the distinction. Name what is finished, what was deferred, what the customer asked to hear, and who owns the next arrangement without declaring the whole visit complete or incomplete.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which work is complete?

- A A booked follow-up visit
- C Rear-bed planting

- B Front-path leaf clearance
- D Rear-bed diagnosis

2. What happened to the rear-bed review?

- A The customer cancelled all work permanently
- C It was completed with a confirmed diagnosis

- B The lead deferred it; no planting or diagnosis was done
- D The crew planted the bed

3. What does the customer request?

- A A report that diagnosis is finished
- C A confirmed visit on Friday

- B A callback about the rear bed before Friday
- D Completed planting before Friday

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

handover

Transfer of relevant work information and responsibility.

IN USE give a clear handover

completed task

Defined work confirmed as finished.

IN USE identify the completed task

deferred review

Assessment postponed rather than completed.

IN USE record a deferred review

rear bed

Planting area at the back of the site.

IN USE identify the rear bed

leaf removal

Clearing fallen leaves from a specified location.

IN USE confirm front-path leaf removal

planting

Placing plants in a prepared location.

IN USE distinguish planting from review

callback

Return telephone contact responding to a request.

IN USE request a callback

callback deadline

Requested or agreed latest time for a return call.

IN USE preserve the callback deadline

scheduling owner

Person responsible for arranging dates or contact.

IN USE identify the scheduling owner

unbooked visit

Possible attendance without a confirmed appointment.

IN USE describe an unbooked visit

status summary

Concise account of each relevant work stage.

IN USE provide a status summary

pending item

Matter not yet resolved or finished.

IN USE flag a pending item

08

Precision check

Front-path leaf clearance is complete. The rear-bed review was deferred by the lead, with no planting or diagnosis performed. Before Friday applies to the requested callback. It is not a booked visit date or a promise to complete work on the bed.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

lead decision

Direction made by the person supervising the work.

IN USE record the lead decision

review outcome

Finding or decision resulting from an assessment.

IN USE avoid inventing a review outcome

follow-up contact

Later communication about an unresolved matter.

IN USE arrange follow-up contact

site attendance

Presence at the property for a stated purpose.

IN USE distinguish site attendance from a callback

completion record

Note identifying work confirmed as finished.

IN USE update the completion record

unperformed work

Task that has not been carried out.

IN USE identify unperformed work

appointment status

Whether a visit is booked, proposed, or unresolved.

IN USE confirm appointment status

customer priority

Matter the customer treats as important.

IN USE preserve the customer priority

communication request

Request for information or contact.

IN USE pass a communication request

open action

Next step not yet completed.

IN USE assign an open action

ownership transfer

Passing responsibility for a defined follow-up.

IN USE confirm ownership transfer

closeout

Final review or closure of a job or issue.

IN USE avoid premature closeout

08

Precision check

Ava owns scheduling, but that ownership does not mean an appointment already exists. The handoff should preserve the customer request and the pending arrangement. Avoid changing deferred into diagnosed, callback into site attendance, or front-path completion into whole-job closeout.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

OPEN WITH THE COMPLETED ITEM

"The front-path leaves are cleared."

EXPLAIN THE DECISION

"The lead deferred that review."

PRESERVE THE CUSTOMER REQUEST

"The customer wants a callback about the rear bed."

DISTINGUISH CONTACT AND ATTENDANCE

"That is a request for a call, not a booked visit."

NAME THE PENDING AREA

"The rear-bed review remains outstanding."

STATE WHAT WAS NOT DONE

"No planting or diagnosis was carried out there."

GIVE THE REQUESTED DEADLINE

"The callback is requested before Friday."

NAME THE OWNER

"Ava owns the scheduling follow-up."

08

Cleared

A completion statement limited to the front-path leaves.

Deferred

Postponed; it does not mean inspected, diagnosed, or permanently cancelled.

Before Friday

The requested callback deadline, not necessarily Friday itself.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

STATE APPOINTMENT STATUS

"No visit date is booked."

SEPARATE THE TWO AREAS

"The front path is complete; the rear bed is a pending item."

AVOID A PLANTING PROMISE

"No planting commitment was made during this visit."

PRESERVE THE UNRESOLVED DETAIL

"The date of any site attendance remains open."

AVOID INVENTING AN OUTCOME

"There is no review finding to report."

KEEP THE REQUEST SPECIFIC

"The callback concerns the deferred rear-bed review."

READ BACK THE ACTION

"Scheduling to follow up on the requested callback before Friday."

CLOSE THE HANDOFF

"Please keep the completed task and the pending review as separate entries."

08

Callback versus visit

Communication and physical attendance are different commitments.

Owns scheduling

Identifies responsibility without establishing an appointment.

Separate entries

Prevents one completed task from obscuring an unresolved item.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which handoff preserves the two work statuses?

- A** All grounds work finished and diagnosed.
- B** Nothing was completed anywhere.
- C** Rear bed planted but path untouched.
- D** Front-path leaves cleared; rear-bed review deferred; no planting or diagnosis.

2. What does before Friday refer to?

- A** The requested callback
- B** A confirmed site visit
- C** Completed planting
- D** A finished diagnosis

3. Which appointment statement is supported?

- A** Ava has already booked Friday.
- B** The crew will definitely return tomorrow.
- C** Scheduling ownership proves a visit is confirmed.
- D** Ava owns scheduling, but no visit date is booked.

4. Which closure would misstate the case?

- A** Front-path leaf clearance complete
- B** Rear-bed review remains pending
- C** Callback request passed to Ava
- D** Entire visit closed with all follow-up complete

Answers and explanations: [page 99](#).

A clear path and an open bed review

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

scheduling owner / review outcome / communication request / closeout / pending item / appointment status / open action / callback deadline / deferred review / completed task

08

- 01 **Rosa:** Ava, Pine Court handover: the front-path leaves are cleared. The rear-bed review needs to stay open.
- 02 **Ava:** Let me separate the entries. The ¹ _____ is front-path leaf clearance. What is the current status of the rear-bed item, and what does the customer need from us?
- 03 **Rosa:** The lead deferred the rear review. No planting or diagnosis was done there; I've no finding to pass on.
- 04 **Ava:** I will record a ² _____, not a completed inspection. I will also state that no planting or diagnosis took place in that area.
- 05 **Rosa:** The customer wants a callback about the rear bed before Friday. Please keep that timing with the request.
- 06 **Ava:** I have the ³ _____ as before Friday. Does the customer already have a booked visit, or is the request only for contact about the next step?
- 07 **Rosa:** No visit is booked. They want a call about the next step, not a confirmed attendance on Friday.
- 08 **Ava:** Then the ⁴ _____ remains unbooked. I will not put Friday down as a confirmed attendance date just because it appears in the callback request.
- 09 **Rosa:** Please don't let the cleared path close the rear-bed item. They have different statuses.
- 10 **Ava:** I will keep a separate ⁵ _____ for the rear bed. The cleared front path can be recorded accurately without closing the unresolved review.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Rosa:** You'll take the scheduling follow-up, correct? I want the next reader to know who owns it.
- 12 **Ava:** Yes, I am the ⁶ _____. That identifies responsibility, but it does not mean a date has already been arranged or a visit has been confirmed.
- 13 **Rosa:** Please keep deferred as the lead's decision. It wasn't a diagnosis that planting or treatment was needed.
- 14 **Ava:** I will not invent a ⁷ _____. The note will describe the deferral and the absence of planting or diagnosis, rather than supply a reasoned finding we do not have.
- 15 **Rosa:** Could you read the timing back? Before Friday means the callback request, not completed bed work.
- 16 **Ava:** The ⁸ _____ is a callback about the rear bed before Friday. There is no promise of planting, diagnosis, or completed work by that time.
- 17 **Rosa:** That's right. Any later visit still needs arranging; we've only passed the request for contact.
- 18 **Ava:** I will retain that as an ⁹ _____. The record will name me as the owner and will not say the callback has already happened.
- 19 **Rosa:** Thanks. The path can be marked complete without making the unfinished rear review disappear.
- 20 **Ava:** Agreed. I will avoid premature ¹⁰ _____. The handover will retain the completed front task, deferred rear review, requested callback deadline, and unbooked visit status as separate facts.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. completed task | 2. deferred review | 3. callback deadline | 4. appointment status | 5. pending item | 6. scheduling owner | 7. review outcome | 8. communication request | 9. open action | 10. closeout

Hand over four distinct facts

F Say it

Complete the office handoff. Preserve the finished front task, deferred rear review, requested callback timing, and absence of a booked visit.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

deferred / booked / Friday / cleared

08

Worker: "The front-path leaves are ¹ _____."

Coordinator: "The rear-bed review was ² _____ by the lead."

Worker: "The customer requests a callback before ³ _____."

Coordinator: "I own scheduling, but no visit is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. cleared | 2. deferred | 3. Friday | 4. booked

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read front path complete and rear-bed review deferred as two separate entries.
2. Repeat before Friday as the requested callback timing, not a booked visit.
3. Read Ava's scheduling ownership while leaving the actual appointment unbooked.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Area is not the order volume

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Read back area, specified depth, purchasing allowance, and whole-bag rounding as separate quantities.

Fictional estimator's worksheet: two non-overlapping rectangles, 12 m by 2 m and 4 m by 3 m, include 4 square meters of marked exclusions. The approved new layer is 50 mm. For purchasing only, add 10% to net volume and round up to whole 50-liter bags. This is supplied estimating arithmetic, not a general mulch-depth recommendation.

PEOPLE / Dev: Grounds worker | Ava: Estimator

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

09

WORD + PHRASE BANK

volume / gross area / allowance / round up / rounding surplus / net area

- 01 **Dev:** Ava, the worksheet says thirty-six square meters. I was about to use that as the number of bags, but the units don't look right.
- 02 **Ava:** Start with the ¹ _____: twelve times two is twenty-four; four times three is twelve. Together they give thirty-six square meters before the exclusions.
- 03 **Dev:** The marked exclusions total four square meters and are inside those rectangles. So I subtract four once, leaving thirty-two to cover.
- 04 **Ava:** That's the ² _____. Keep the exclusions in the takeoff; don't buy or apply material as though every part of the rectangles needs coverage.
- 05 **Dev:** The new layer is specified as fifty millimeters. I need meters for multiplying by square meters, so that's zero point zero five meters.
- 06 **Ava:** Then the net ³ _____ is thirty-two times zero point zero five: one point six cubic meters, or sixteen hundred liters.
- 07 **Dev:** At fifty liters per bag, the net material is thirty-two bags. But the purchasing instruction also asks for ten percent extra.
- 08 **Ava:** Apply the ⁴ _____ to the net volume, not to the depth specification. Sixteen hundred plus one hundred sixty gives seventeen hundred sixty liters.
- 09 **Dev:** Dividing that by fifty gives thirty-five point two bags. We can't order point two of one of these bags.
- 10 **Ava:** So ⁵ _____ to thirty-six whole bags. Thirty-five would give seventeen hundred fifty liters, ten liters below the purchasing target.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 76.

- 11 **Dev:** Thirty-six bags gives eighteen hundred liters. That's forty liters beyond the allowance-adjusted target, because of the bag increment.
- 12 **Ava:** Correct. That is ⁶ _____, not another planned layer. Keep net requirement, allowance, and bag rounding separate in the estimate.
- 13 **Dev:** Could someone read thirty-six bags as an instruction to spread all thirty-six across the thirty-two square meters?
- 14 **Ava:** They shouldn't. Extra purchasing quantity doesn't change the approved fifty-millimeter new layer or remove the marked exclusions. Don't thicken the layer to consume leftovers.
- 15 **Dev:** And fifty millimeters is the specification for this fictional worksheet. It isn't a rule for every plant, site, or existing mulch condition.
- 16 **Ava:** Exactly. Actual depth and placement require the relevant design and site assessment. We're practicing how to explain the supplied calculation, not choosing horticultural requirements.
- 17 **Dev:** My estimate should therefore list thirty-two square meters net, one point six cubic meters net material, and one point seven six with allowance.
- 18 **Ava:** Then thirty-six fifty-liter bags as the rounded purchasing quantity. Show the bag volume so nobody substitutes a smaller bag at the same count.
- 19 **Dev:** I'll preserve the two rectangle dimensions and four-square-meter exclusions with it. That makes the total traceable if the drawing changes.
- 20 **Ava:** Good. This is a quantity calculation for review, not confirmation that material is ordered, delivered, or applied. Those statuses need their own records.

09

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. gross area | 2. net area | 3. volume | 4. allowance | 5. round up | 6. rounding surplus

A different bag size

F Say it in a new situation

A fictional worksheet gives a net area of 18 square meters and a specified new layer of 40 mm. Add a purchasing allowance of 5% to net volume, then round up to whole 40-liter bags. Do not change the layer depth.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

four / nineteen / 720 / 756

09

Worker: The net volume is ¹ _____ liters.

Estimator: Including five percent, the purchasing target is ² _____ liters.

Worker: The rounded order quantity is ³ _____ bags.

Estimator: Whole bags provide ⁴ _____ liters beyond that purchasing target.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. 720 | 2. 756 | 3. nineteen | 4. four

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Read the whole plant name

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Check a plant schedule against delivered labels while keeping species, cultivar, quantity, and container volume distinct.

Fictional planting schedule L3 calls for 12 *Lavandula angustifolia* 'Hidcote', in containers labeled 2 L. Delivery labels show 8 'Hidcote' in 2 L containers and 4 'Munstead' in 2 L containers, all *Lavandula angustifolia*. No substitution is approved. Health, identity verification beyond labels, and planting suitability remain for the qualified lead.

PEOPLE / Tomas: Grounds worker | Imani: Landscape lead

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

10

WORD + PHRASE BANK

cultivar / botanical name / substitution / specification discrepancy / container volume / container label

- 01 **Tomas:** Imani, the delivery has twelve English lavenders, so the count looks right. But four labels don't have the same name as schedule L3.
- 02 **Imani:** Read the ¹ _____ in full, including the cultivar. L3 calls for *Lavandula angustifolia* Hidcote, twelve plants in containers labeled two liters.
- 03 **Tomas:** Eight labels say Hidcote. Four say Munstead. They all say *Lavandula angustifolia*, so the species wording matches.
- 04 **Imani:** But the ² _____ doesn't match on those four. Hidcote and Munstead aren't interchangeable names just because both are English lavender.
- 05 **Tomas:** Then I'd report twelve plants physically delivered, with eight matching the specified cultivar label and four labeled differently. Not simply twelve correct.
- 06 **Imani:** Yes. That's a ³ _____, not a total-count shortage. We are four short of the specified cultivar on the label evidence.
- 07 **Tomas:** All the containers are marked two liters. Does that tell us the plants are the specified height as well?
- 08 **Imani:** No. That's ⁴ _____, not a height measurement. It doesn't tell us mature spread or establish that every plant meets every requirement.
- 09 **Tomas:** So two liters isn't two meters, and a two-liter container doesn't mean the plant will stay that size as it grows.
- 10 **Imani:** Correct. Keep count, plant identity, and size information in their own fields. A matching ⁵ _____ does not cancel the cultivar discrepancy.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 79.

- 11 **Tomas:** Could the four Munstead be accepted as substitutes if someone says the flower color looks close enough?
- 12 **Imani:** A ⁶ _____ needs the actual review and approval. Similar appearance isn't permission to change the planting schedule.
- 13 **Tomas:** I'll leave the original L3 specification visible. I shouldn't edit Hidcote out of it so that the delivery appears to match.
- 14 **Imani:** Exactly. Preserve what was requested and what the labels show. That gives the supplier a clear discrepancy to address.
- 15 **Tomas:** Should I call the eight Hidcote plants fully accepted, since their labels and two-liter containers match the schedule?
- 16 **Imani:** Not yet. The case only establishes label matches. Plant health, actual identity checks, and the other acceptance requirements still need the qualified review.
- 17 **Tomas:** I'll keep the labels with the delivery record, not rewrite them or plant the four differently labeled ones to keep the job moving.
- 18 **Imani:** Good. The review needs both cultivar names, quantities, container information, and schedule reference L3. Don't shorten it to lavender problem.
- 19 **Tomas:** Read-back: twelve delivered; eight Hidcote, four Munstead, all labeled *Lavandula angustifolia* in two-liter containers; twelve Hidcote requested; no substitute approved.
- 20 **Imani:** That's precise. We can resolve the specification question from that record without confusing a correct total with a fully matching delivery.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. botanical name | 2. cultivar | 3. specification discrepancy | 4. container volume | 5. container label | 6. substitution

Separate variety and container size

F Say it in a new situation

A fictional schedule requires 10 *Lavandula angustifolia* 'Munstead' in containers labeled 3 L. Delivery labels show 6 'Munstead' in 3 L, 2 'Munstead' in 2 L, and 2 'Hidcote' in 3 L. No alternatives are approved; other quality checks remain.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

six / ten / container size / cultivar

Worker: ¹ _____ plants match both the specified cultivar and container label.

Lead: Two Munstead plants have a ² _____ discrepancy.

Worker: Two three-liter plants have a ³ _____ discrepancy.

Lead: The total delivered count is ⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. six | 2. container size | 3. cultivar | 4. ten

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.

2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.

3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

An average can hide dry spots

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Explain measured application rate and lower-quarter distribution uniformity without confusing either with a watering prescription.

Fictional completed irrigation audit: 16 equally representative catch positions measured during the same 20-minute test; four readings each of 10, 12, 14, and 16 mm. Use mean depth divided by minutes times 60 for mm/hour. Lower-quarter uniformity equals the lowest-quarter mean divided by the overall mean. No watering schedule or fault diagnosis is supplied.

PEOPLE / Leila: Grounds worker | Marco: Irrigation lead

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

application efficiency / mean depth / ratio / precipitation rate / distribution uniformity / lower-quarter mean

11

- 01 **Leila:** Marco, the audit sheet has sixteen readings. Four are ten millimeters, four twelve, four fourteen, and four sixteen. They all came from the same twenty-minute test.
- 02 **Marco:** Then the ¹ _____ is thirteen millimeters. Each group has the same number of readings, so averaging those four group values also gives thirteen.
- 03 **Leila:** That's what accumulated during twenty minutes. To express the application rate per hour, I multiply thirteen by three.
- 04 **Marco:** Correct. The measured average ² _____ is thirty-nine millimeters per hour under those test conditions. It doesn't mean thirty-nine millimeters fell during the test.
- 05 **Leila:** And thirteen is only the mean. The lowest positions collected ten and the highest sixteen, so the coverage wasn't the same everywhere.
- 06 **Marco:** That's why we also examine ³ _____. An acceptable-looking average can't tell you whether the whole area received similar amounts.
- 07 **Leila:** For the lower quarter, I take four of the sixteen readings. The lowest four are all ten millimeters.
- 08 **Marco:** Their ⁴ _____ is ten millimeters. Divide ten by the overall mean of thirteen, not by the highest reading of sixteen.
- 09 **Leila:** Ten divided by thirteen is about zero point seven six nine. Expressed as a percentage, that's about seventy-seven percent.
- 10 **Marco:** Yes, to the nearest whole percent. Keep the unrounded ⁵ _____ in the calculation and round the reported percentage at the end.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 82.

- 11 **Leila:** Does that mean seventy-seven percent of the water reached the roots and twenty-three percent was wasted?
- 12 **Marco:** No. That's not an ⁶ _____ result. These catch readings don't tell us how much water the soil stored in the root zone.
- 13 **Leila:** Could I tell the customer to run the system longer so the dry positions catch up? The numbers don't tell me the plants' needs.
- 14 **Marco:** Don't prescribe a schedule from this alone. Soil, plant needs, weather, restrictions, and the actual system assessment matter. More run time doesn't itself correct uneven distribution.
- 15 **Leila:** And the spread of readings doesn't prove which nozzle or component is faulty. We have measurements, not the cause.
- 16 **Marco:** Right. Preserve the position identifiers and test conditions for review. A repair decision needs the relevant inspection rather than a guessed component failure.
- 17 **Leila:** The note should say thirteen millimeters mean depth in twenty minutes, equivalent average rate thirty-nine per hour, lower-quarter uniformity about seventy-seven percent.
- 18 **Marco:** That's accurate, with the units stated. Keep the sixteen readings available so the mean doesn't hide the low and high positions.
- 19 **Leila:** I'll report those findings as the completed measurement review, not say every part received thirteen millimeters or that a new schedule is approved.
- 20 **Marco:** Exactly. The measurements describe this test. They don't certify the entire installation, diagnose a fault, or authorize a controller change.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. mean depth | 2. precipitation rate | 3. distribution uniformity | 4. lower-quarter mean | 5. ratio | 6. application efficiency

Compare a second set of readings

F Say it in a new situation

A fictional 30-minute test has 16 equally representative positions: four readings each of 6, 8, 10, and 12 mm. Use the same mean-rate and lower-quarter formulas. Round the final uniformity percentage to one decimal place.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

eighteen / 66.7 / nine / six

Worker: Mean collected depth is ¹ _____ millimeters.

Lead: The average application rate is ² _____ millimeters per hour.

Worker: The lowest-quarter mean is ³ _____ millimeters.

Lead: Lower-quarter uniformity is ⁴ _____ percent.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. nine | 2. eighteen | 3. six | 4. 66.7

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

01 Briefing and language checks

Confirming the booked grounds work

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What is included today?

D. Front-lawn mowing and path leaf clearance

The booking names front-lawn mowing and path leaf clearance as the included work.

2. Which task does Ben add?

C. Rear-hedge shaping

Ben requests shaping of the rear hedge beyond the current booking.

3. What can Asha offer?

D. Office review of a separate request, with no confirmed price or date

The office can review the additional request, but its terms and timing are not confirmed.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which scope explanation matches the booking?

D. Today covers front-lawn mowing and path leaf clearance, not the rear hedge.

The work order includes the two named front-area tasks and excludes hedge work.

2. Which next-step statement is accurate?

D. I can pass the separate hedge request to the office for review.

Referring the request is available, while approval, cost, and timing remain open.

3. Which statement overpromises?

B. The hedge will definitely be shaped today at no charge.

Neither same-day service nor a free price is supplied or authorized.

4. What should remain in the handoff?

D. Rear-hedge shaping requested; separate review needed; price and date unknown.

The handoff must preserve the actual request and the unresolved approval, price, and timing.

01 Conversation answers

Confirming the booked grounds work

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

1. work order. Turn 2. Work order specifies today's front-lawn mowing and path leaf clearance, rather than every grounds task.

2. booked scope. Turn 4. Booked scope limits the current visit to the agreed tasks; sharing a property does not add hedge work.

3. rear hedge. Turn 6. Rear hedge identifies the exact subject of the additional request and keeps it separate from the front-lawn task.

4. separate quotation. Turn 8. Separate quotation would provide a price for the additional work; none has been given or accepted here.

5. service date. Turn 10. Service date for the hedge remains unconfirmed and must not be presented as an appointment this week.

6. Office review. Turn 12. Office review assesses the new request and is separate from approval or an entered booking.

7. task authorization. Turn 14. Task authorization is still needed for the actual hedge work; changing the informal description does not add approval.

8. request handoff. Turn 16. Request handoff transfers the accurately described hedge request while leaving approval, price, and date unresolved.

9. included task. Turn 18. Included task identifies front-lawn mowing, alongside path leaf clearance, as work actually named for today's visit.

10. scope change. Turn 20. No scope change is approved; the separate hedge request is only being passed for review.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. mowing

Worker: "The booked lawn task is mowing."

Mowing is the included lawn task in the existing work order.

2. side hedge

Resident: "The additional request concerns the side hedge."

Side hedge is the subject of the separate shaping request.

3. review

Worker: "The next step is office review."

Review is the available process for assessing the additional task.

4. unconfirmed

Resident: "The price and date are still unconfirmed."

No quotation or service appointment has been established for the extra work.

02 Briefing and language checks

Clarifying access and property limits

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. Where does the current work plan end?

A. At the rear fence

The supplied work plan ends at the rear fence and has not been extended.

2. What is known about the strip's ownership?

D. It is unconfirmed

Rosa says probably, which does not establish who owns the strip.

3. What can Kai do?

B. Flag the request and uncertainty to the office

Kai can refer the issue but has no authority to determine ownership or expand the work area.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which report preserves the uncertainty?

B. Rosa believes the strip may be theirs; ownership is unconfirmed.

The correct report attributes Rosa's belief while retaining the lack of confirmation.

2. What does the rear fence establish in this scenario?

C. The endpoint of the current work plan.

The fence is the supplied work-plan reference, not a legal ownership determination.

3. Which action is within Kai's stated role?

D. Refer the request and access uncertainty to the office.

Kai can flag the issue but cannot decide ownership or extend the plan.

4. Which statement wrongly combines separate questions?

C. If the customer believes it is theirs, entry and clearance are automatically approved.

An uncertain ownership belief establishes neither access permission nor authorization for additional work.

02 Conversation answers

Clarifying access and property limits

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. land strip.** Turn 2. Land strip identifies the narrow area beyond the rear fence, separate from the current planned work area.
- 2. work-plan limit.** Turn 4. Work-plan limit is the rear fence, which defines assigned work without deciding the legal property boundary.
- 3. additional request.** Turn 6. Additional request records Rosa's proposed extra work but does not itself extend the approved area.
- 4. qualified statement.** Turn 8. Qualified statement preserves probably or may, rather than changing an uncertain ownership belief into a verified fact.
- 5. fence alignment.** Turn 10. Fence alignment is an observed location feature and does not establish ownership or the property's legal limit in this case.
- 6. office referral.** Turn 12. Office referral passes the precise clearance request and unresolved access question to the coordinating office for review.
- 7. scope extension.** Turn 14. Scope extension would expand the work area beyond the fence, which has not been approved.
- 8. boundary clarification.** Turn 16. Boundary clarification requires the appropriate review process, not an on-site ownership decision by the grounds worker.
- 9. beyond the fence.** Turn 18. Beyond the fence precisely locates the additional area outside the current work-plan limit.
- 10. revised plan.** Turn 20. Revised plan remains unconfirmed; referring the request has not approved entry or clearance beyond the fence.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. gate

Worker: "The current plan ends at the side gate."

The side gate is the stated endpoint of the existing work plan.

2. may

Customer: "The area may belong to the property."

May preserves the customer's uncertain ownership statement rather than asserting a fact.

3. unconfirmed

Worker: "Ownership remains unconfirmed."

No evidence in the scenario establishes who owns the requested area.

4. review

Customer: "The next step is office review."

The request can be reviewed, but entry and clearance are not yet authorized.

03 Briefing and language checks

Clarifying appearance and plant requests

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. Which plant does Nina mean?

B. The rosemary beside the left flower bed

Nina clarifies that the rosemary, not the magnolia, is the requested plant.

2. What result does she request?

A. A neater appearance

Nina describes an appearance goal without specifying a suitable method or extent.

3. What remains necessary?

D. Qualified lead review of whether and how pruning fits the job

Plant identification resolves the reference but does not establish authorization or appropriate pruning.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which clarification resolves the ambiguity?

A. Do you mean the rosemary beside the left flower bed, not the magnolia?

The question identifies the intended plant and explicitly distinguishes the nearby alternative.

2. Which record preserves Nina's request?

C. Rosemary beside the left flower bed; neater appearance requested; lead review needed.

The record preserves the plant, appearance goal, and unresolved qualified assessment.

3. Which statement goes beyond the facts?

B. The rosemary definitely needs a specific amount cut off today.

Neither a suitable amount nor same-day cutting permission has been established.

4. What can Tomas confirm now?

C. The plant and the requested visual goal

Tomas can clarify the reference and preference while leaving technical and scope decisions open.

03 Conversation answers

Clarifying appearance and plant requests

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

- 1. plant identification.** Turn 2. Plant identification establishes the intended subject before the worker records or refers any pruning request.
- 2. reference point.** Turn 4. Reference point uses the left flower bed to distinguish the rosemary from the nearby magnolia.
- 3. appearance goal.** Turn 6. Appearance goal records the visual result Nina wants without inventing a pruning method or amount.
- 4. pruning extent.** Turn 8. Pruning extent concerns how much work would be appropriate; Nina has not specified or authorized that amount.
- 5. customer preference.** Turn 10. Customer preference is for a neater appearance, not plant removal or a particular technical treatment.
- 6. Scope fit.** Turn 12. Scope fit asks whether the requested pruning belongs to the agreed job; the conversation has not settled that question.
- 7. proposed method.** Turn 14. Proposed method remains a matter for qualified assessment rather than a cutting instruction supplied by the customer.
- 8. left-hand bed.** Turn 16. Left-hand bed preserves Nina's specific location and helps the lead identify the correct plant at the entrance.
- 9. Cutting authorization.** Turn 18. Cutting authorization has not been granted merely by clarifying the plant and describing a preferred appearance.
- 10. qualified assessment.** Turn 20. Qualified assessment is the next step for the request; no pruning result, method, or completion is promised.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. rosemary

Worker: "You mean the rosemary beside the left flower bed."

Rosemary is the plant Nina explicitly identifies beside the left bed.

2. magnolia

Customer: "The magnolia is not part of my request."

Nina excludes the nearby magnolia from the appearance request.

3. neater

Worker: "Your goal is a neater appearance."

Neater preserves the customer preference without prescribing a pruning method.

4. assess

Customer: "The qualified lead still needs to assess it."

Assessment remains necessary before any method, extent, or authorization is established.

04 Briefing and language checks

Explaining a weather-related change

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. Why is the work paused?

D. Site conditions after rain

The lead has paused the planned work because of the site conditions after rain.

2. What is the status of Thursday?

B. Suggested, with crew availability unconfirmed

Thursday is only an office suggestion because crew availability has not been confirmed.

3. What communication can Imani request?

C. A scheduling update by Wednesday noon

Imani can request the update while preserving the unresolved visit and completion dates.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which explanation preserves all three dates?

D. Thursday is suggested; an update is requested by Wednesday noon; the event is Friday.

The explanation assigns each date its actual role without converting suggestions into promises.

2. Which statement should be corrected?

A. Thursday is definitely booked and everything will be finished before Friday.

Neither the Thursday booking nor completion before the event is confirmed.

3. What should Imani send the office?

C. The Friday event detail and a request for a scheduling update by Wednesday noon

These are the customer constraint and communication request actually supported by the case.

4. What does unconfirmed availability mean?

B. The crew arrangement still needs verification

Unconfirmed preserves the open check rather than asserting availability or unavailability.

04 Conversation answers

Explaining a weather-related change

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

1. work status. Turn 2. Work status is paused because of site conditions after rain; the conversation does not establish completion or resumption.

2. tentative date. Turn 4. Tentative date describes Thursday as a suggestion rather than a confirmed return visit or guaranteed completion date.

3. customer constraint. Turn 6. Customer constraint is the Friday event, which affects planning but does not authorize resuming work or promise completion.

4. scheduling update. Turn 8. Scheduling update is the information Imani can request by Wednesday noon; it is not the work itself.

5. confirmation status. Turn 10. Confirmation status keeps Thursday open because the office has not established crew availability or a confirmed return arrangement.

6. event deadline. Turn 12. Event deadline records Friday as the customer's planning constraint without treating it as an agreed service deadline.

7. resumption. Turn 14. Resumption means restarting paused work; a proposed date alone does not authorize it or establish suitable conditions.

8. outstanding check. Turn 16. Outstanding check is crew availability, which remains unresolved and must not be silently treated as confirmed.

9. office coordinator. Turn 18. Office coordinator is the scheduling contact who receives the event constraint and the requested communication time.

10. service interruption. Turn 20. Service interruption refers to the paused planned work, with a suggested return day and an unresolved scheduling arrangement.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. paused

Lead: "The work remains paused because of the site conditions."

Paused is the stated work status after rain affected the site.

2. suggested

Customer: "Thursday is suggested, not confirmed."

Thursday was proposed by the office, but crew availability remains unconfirmed.

3. noon

Lead: "I will request an update by Wednesday noon."

Noon completes the requested Wednesday communication time, not a work deadline.

4. Friday

Customer: "My event is on Friday."

Friday is the event date and does not establish a completion guarantee.

04

05 Briefing and language checks

Reporting site observations without diagnosis

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What did Leila observe?

D. Standing water beside the east bed at 09:15

The observation is standing water at the stated place and time, not a confirmed fault.

2. What has not occurred?

B. An irrigation-system check

The case explicitly says no system check has occurred.

3. Who can arrange review?

A. Grounds lead Marco

Marco is the lead who can arrange review, but no repair appointment is confirmed.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which report is supported?

B. Standing water beside the east bed near zone 3 at 09:15; cause unknown.

Only the visible water, location, time, and unknown cause are established.

2. How should Leila answer the pipe question?

B. I cannot confirm that; no system check has occurred.

The response preserves uncertainty without asserting or excluding an untested cause.

3. Which detail must not be silently changed?

A. Near zone 3 must not become a confirmed fault in zone 3.

A location reference does not establish that the nearby system zone caused the water.

4. Which next step is accurate?

D. Refer the observation to Marco, who can arrange review.

The lead can arrange review, while inspection findings and repair arrangements remain unknown.

05 Conversation answers

Reporting site observations without diagnosis

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. standing water. Turn 2. Standing water names the visible condition without identifying the cause or proving a pipe failure.

2. irrigation zone. Turn 4. Irrigation zone identifies the nearby numbered area; proximity does not establish that the zone is faulty.

3. system check. Turn 6. System check has not occurred, so no test result or confirmed cause can be included in the report.

4. observation time. Turn 8. Observation time is 09:15, when Leila saw the water; it is not a failure time or inspection appointment.

5. suspected cause. Turn 10. Suspected cause preserves Evan's pipe question as a possibility rather than a diagnosis or established finding.

6. review owner. Turn 12. Review owner identifies Marco as the person who can arrange review of the reported condition.

7. visible condition. Turn 14. Visible condition is the water Leila observed; reporting it does not establish a repair booking or technical conclusion.

8. confirmed fault. Turn 16. Confirmed fault would claim a problem had been established through checking; no such finding exists in the case.

9. site location. Turn 18. Site location is beside the east bed near zone 3, which distinguishes this observation from other planting beds.

10. inspection request. Turn 20. Inspection request asks for review of the observation; it does not mean an inspection or repair has already happened.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. water

Worker: "I observed standing water beside the east bed."

Water is the visible condition reported, not a confirmed damaged component.

2. 09:15

Worker: "The observation time was 09:15."

This is when Leila saw the condition, not when a fault began.

3. 3

Worker: "The area is near zone 3."

Zone 3 is the location reference, not proof of a faulty zone.

4. unknown

Worker: "The cause is unknown; no system check has occurred."

No examination has established the cause of the standing water.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Checking materials and requested quantities

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What quantity is listed and what arrived?

D. Eight bags listed; six delivered; two short

Subtracting six delivered bags from eight listed bags gives a two-bag shortage.

2. Which description raises a second question?

D. Natural brown on the delivered label versus the approved dark sample

The delivered label differs from the requested dark description and approved sample.

3. What is the next step?

D. Office query to the supplier about both discrepancies

The office will query both quantity and description without assuming substitution or coverage approval.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which calculation is correct?

B. Eight requested minus six delivered equals two bags short.

Comparing the expected and received counts shows a shortage of two bags.

2. Which statement preserves the color issue?

C. The label says natural brown, while the approved sample was dark.

The statement compares the actual label with the approved reference without claiming a match.

3. How should Dev answer whether six bags are enough?

A. I cannot promise coverage from the information we have.

The case lacks the measurements and application information needed for a coverage promise.

4. What belongs in the supplier query?

D. Both the two-bag shortage and the material-description discrepancy

Both unresolved differences need review; neither acceptance nor replacement timing is established.

06 Conversation answers

Checking materials and requested quantities

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

- 1. bag count.** Turn 2. Bag count is six delivered bags, which must be compared with the eight bags listed in the job.
- 2. product label.** Turn 4. Product label supplies the delivered description natural brown; it does not explain why that material was delivered.
- 3. coverage.** Turn 6. Coverage depends on information not supplied here; six bags cannot be declared sufficient simply because they arrived.
- 4. requested quantity.** Turn 8. Requested quantity remains eight bags; receiving six does not amend the original job requirement.
- 5. approved sample.** Turn 10. Approved sample is the dark reference Mira accepted; the delivered label has not been verified against it as a match.
- 6. supplier query.** Turn 12. Supplier query is the agreed next route for investigating both quantity and material description, without assuming acceptance.
- 7. replacement request.** Turn 14. Replacement request is not yet confirmed as an order or delivery arrangement; the current step is a supplier query.
- 8. Substitution approval.** Turn 16. Substitution approval has not been given; asking about possibilities does not authorize an alternative material.
- 9. quantity discrepancy.** Turn 18. Quantity discrepancy is two bags short, while the material-description discrepancy remains a separate unresolved issue.
- 10. acceptance.** Turn 20. Acceptance of the delivery is not established; the office must resolve the quantity and material questions through the supplier.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. eight

Worker: "The job requires eight bags of dark mulch."

Eight is the requested quantity and remains unchanged by the delivery.

2. six

Worker: "We received six bags."

Six is the delivered count, not a revised order quantity.

3. two

Worker: "We are two bags short."

Eight requested minus six delivered leaves a shortage of two bags.

4. brown

Worker: "The label says natural brown; substitution is not approved."

Natural brown is the delivered description, which differs from the dark reference.

07 Briefing and language checks

Responding to finish and cleanup concerns

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What can Amir see?

C. Clippings beside the front steps

The worker can see clippings in the front-step area identified by the customer.

2. Which area is included?

C. The front steps within the listed cleanup area

The front steps fall within the listed cleanup area, while the rear patio is excluded.

3. What can the lead organize?

A. The missed front cleanup

The lead can organize correction of the missed included work without adding wider tasks.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which opening best acknowledges the evidence?

D. I can see clippings beside the front steps, within the cleanup area.

The opening recognizes the directly visible problem in the included area.

2. Which scope statement is accurate?

A. The lead can organize missed front cleanup; the rear patio remains excluded.

Correcting the included task does not change the excluded status of the rear patio.

3. Which status should not be recorded yet?

D. Resolved and fully corrected

No completed correction or verified resolution has occurred in the supplied facts.

4. What belongs in the correction request?

B. The exact front-step location, visible clippings, included scope, and pending follow-up

These details preserve the observed problem, its scope, and the unresolved arrangement.

07 Conversation answers

Responding to finish and cleanup concerns

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

1. clippings. Turn 2. Clippings are the visible remaining material beside the front steps, supporting the report of incomplete cleanup.

2. completion status. Turn 4. Completion status of the identified front cleanup is incomplete; leaving the site does not prove that task was finished.

3. missed cleanup. Turn 6. Missed cleanup is an included front-area task left incomplete, which the lead can arrange to address.

4. rear patio. Turn 8. Rear patio is excluded from this booking and does not become included through the front-cleanup correction request.

5. scope boundary. Turn 10. Scope boundary keeps the missed included front cleanup separate from the customer's additional rear-patio request.

6. return time. Turn 12. Return time is not supplied, so Amir cannot promise an exact attendance time for the correction.

7. observation record. Turn 14. Observation record preserves what Amir directly saw, rather than treating the concern as an unsupported general complaint.

8. correction request. Turn 16. Correction request concerns the specific missed front cleanup; it should not claim that every task or area was defective.

9. Resolution. Turn 18. Resolution requires the issue to be addressed; merely passing a message to the lead does not establish that outcome.

10. follow-up arrangement. Turn 20. Follow-up arrangement is still to be organized for the missed front cleanup; no wider task or exact time is agreed.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. steps

Worker: "Clippings remain beside the front steps."

The steps are the exact location of the visible missed cleanup.

2. included

Customer: "That area was included in the booking."

The front-step area belongs to the listed cleanup scope.

3. excluded

Worker: "The rear patio remains excluded."

The patio is outside the booking and is not automatically added.

4. unconfirmed

Worker: "The lead can organize correction; the return time is unconfirmed."

No exact return time is supplied, even though the lead can organize correction.

07

08 Briefing and language checks

Handing over unfinished grounds work

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. Which work is complete?

B. Front-path leaf clearance

The case confirms only that the front-path leaves are cleared.

2. What happened to the rear-bed review?

B. The lead deferred it; no planting or diagnosis was done

The lead deferred the review, leaving both planting and diagnosis unperformed.

3. What does the customer request?

B. A callback about the rear bed before Friday

The requested deadline concerns a callback, not an agreed site visit or completed work.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which handoff preserves the two work statuses?

D. Front-path leaves cleared; rear-bed review deferred; no planting or diagnosis.

The handoff distinguishes the completed front task from the unperformed rear review.

2. What does before Friday refer to?

A. The requested callback

The customer requested communication before Friday, not an appointment or work-completion promise.

3. Which appointment statement is supported?

D. Ava owns scheduling, but no visit date is booked.

Responsibility for scheduling does not establish that an appointment has been made.

4. Which closure would misstate the case?

D. Entire visit closed with all follow-up complete

A pending review and callback request remain, so all follow-up cannot be declared complete.

08 Conversation answers

Handing over unfinished grounds work

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

- 1. completed task.** Turn 2. Completed task is front-path leaf clearance only; it does not include rear-bed assessment, planting, or diagnosis.
- 2. deferred review.** Turn 4. Deferred review means the assessment was postponed, not completed with a finding or converted into planting work.
- 3. callback deadline.** Turn 6. Callback deadline is the customer's request for contact before Friday; it is not a confirmed work or visit deadline.
- 4. appointment status.** Turn 8. Appointment status remains unbooked; the callback request cannot be treated as confirmation of physical attendance.
- 5. pending item.** Turn 10. Pending item is the rear-bed review and its follow-up, which must remain visible alongside the completed front task.
- 6. scheduling owner.** Turn 12. Scheduling owner identifies Ava's responsibility for arrangements; it does not imply that she has already booked a date.
- 7. review outcome.** Turn 14. Review outcome is absent because the rear-bed assessment was deferred and no diagnosis was performed.
- 8. communication request.** Turn 16. Communication request is a callback about the rear bed before Friday, distinct from a booked visit or completed grounds work.
- 9. open action.** Turn 18. Open action is the unresolved scheduling follow-up on the callback request; it is not evidence that contact has already happened.
- 10. closeout.** Turn 20. Closeout of all work would be inaccurate because the rear-bed review and requested follow-up remain unresolved.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. cleared

Worker: "The front-path leaves are cleared."

Cleared confirms the completed front-path task, not all work at the site.

2. deferred

Coordinator: "The rear-bed review was deferred by the lead."

Deferred means postponed; no planting or diagnosis was performed there.

3. Friday

Worker: "The customer requests a callback before Friday."

Friday belongs to the requested callback deadline, not a booked attendance date.

4. booked

Coordinator: "I own scheduling, but no visit is booked."

Scheduling responsibility exists, while the actual visit date remains unconfirmed.

08

09 Conversation answers

Area is not the order volume

E Extended conversation

Pages 76-77

- 1. gross area.** Turn 2. The two non-overlapping rectangles have areas twenty-four and twelve square meters, totaling thirty-six before exclusions.
- 2. net area.** Turn 4. Thirty-six square meters minus four square meters of exclusions leaves thirty-two square meters requiring the new layer.
- 3. volume.** Turn 6. Thirty-two square meters multiplied by 0.05 meters gives 1.6 cubic meters, equivalent to 1,600 liters.
- 4. allowance.** Turn 8. Ten percent of the 1,600-liter net volume is 160 liters; the purchasing target becomes 1,760 liters.
- 5. round up.** Turn 10. The 35.2-bag purchasing target requires thirty-six whole bags; rounding down to thirty-five would provide only 1,750 liters.
- 6. rounding surplus.** Turn 12. The whole-bag order supplies 1,800 liters, forty above the 1,760-liter purchasing target; it is separate from the allowance itself.

F Transfer exchange

Page 78

1. 720

Worker: The net volume is 720 liters.

Eighteen square meters times 0.04 meters equals 0.72 cubic meters, or 720 liters.

2. 756

Estimator: Including five percent, the purchasing target is 756 liters.

Five percent of 720 is 36; adding it gives a target of 756 liters.

3. nineteen

Worker: The rounded order quantity is nineteen bags.

756 divided by 40 is 18.9, which rounds upward to nineteen whole bags.

4. four

Estimator: Whole bags provide four liters beyond that purchasing target.

Nineteen forty-liter bags supply 760 liters; subtracting 756 leaves four liters of rounding surplus.

Background reading: [Iowa State University Extension: area, depth, volume, and bag calculations](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

10 Conversation answers

Read the whole plant name

E Extended conversation

Pages 79-80

1. botanical name. Turn 2. The botanical name *Lavandula angustifolia* identifies the species here; the schedule also specifies a particular cultivar within it.

2. cultivar. Turn 4. Hidcote and Munstead are different named cultivars; matching species and common name do not make the delivered selection identical.

3. specification discrepancy. Turn 6. Four delivered plants carry Munstead labels rather than the specified Hidcote, even though the overall plant count is twelve.

4. container volume. Turn 8. The 2 L marking describes the stated container volume, not plant height, mature spread, or a guarantee of overall quality.

5. container label. Turn 10. The container-size marking matches the supplied 2 L requirement but does not resolve the different cultivar labels.

6. substitution. Turn 12. Using Munstead in place of Hidcote would be a change to the specified selection and requires the actual approval process.

F Transfer exchange

Page 81

1. six

Worker: six plants match both the specified cultivar and container label.

Only the six Munstead plants in three-liter containers match both supplied requirements.

2. container size

Lead: Two Munstead plants have a container size discrepancy.

Those two have the requested cultivar but two-liter rather than three-liter containers.

3. cultivar

Worker: Two three-liter plants have a cultivar discrepancy.

The Hidcote plants have the stated container size but not the specified Munstead cultivar.

4. ten

Lead: The total delivered count is ten .

Six plus two plus two equals ten delivered plants, despite only six matching both label requirements.

10

Background reading: [Royal Horticultural Society: the Hidcote cultivar of English lavender](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

11 Conversation answers

An average can hide dry spots

E Extended conversation

Pages 82-83

1. mean depth. Turn 2. Four readings at each of 10, 12, 14, and 16 mm total 208 mm; dividing by sixteen gives a mean of 13 mm.

2. precipitation rate. Turn 4. Thirteen millimeters in twenty minutes corresponds to thirty-nine millimeters per hour under the measured test conditions.

3. distribution uniformity. Turn 6. Distribution uniformity describes how evenly water is applied; an average rate alone can hide differences among positions.

4. lower-quarter mean. Turn 8. One quarter of sixteen is four; the four lowest readings are all ten, giving a lower-quarter mean of ten millimeters.

5. ratio. Turn 10. The ratio is 10 divided by 13, approximately 0.769; multiplying by one hundred converts it to about 77 percent.

6. application efficiency. Turn 12. This uniformity ratio compares catch depths; it does not measure the fraction of supplied water stored usefully in the root zone.

F Transfer exchange

Page 84

1. nine

Worker: Mean collected depth is nine millimeters.

The equally sized groups average $(6 + 8 + 10 + 12)$ divided by four, or nine millimeters.

2. eighteen

Lead: The average application rate is eighteen millimeters per hour.

Nine millimeters in thirty minutes is eighteen millimeters per hour, not eighteen collected during the test.

3. six

Worker: The lowest-quarter mean is six millimeters.

The lowest four of sixteen readings are all six millimeters, so their mean is six.

4. 66.7

Lead: Lower-quarter uniformity is 66.7 percent.

Six divided by nine times one hundred is 66.666... percent, rounded to 66.7, not a root-zone efficiency measurement.

11

Background reading: [University of Florida IFAS: lower-quarter irrigation uniformity](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Confirming the booked grounds work

Acknowledge the request: I understand you would like the rear hedge shaped as well.

State the second task: Path leaf clearance is included too.

Avoid a price promise: I do not have a confirmed price for that work.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Clarifying access and property limits

Identify the requested area: You mean the strip beyond the rear fence?

Preserve uncertainty: You said it is probably yours; ownership is not confirmed.

Offer referral: I can flag the request to the office.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Clarifying appearance and plant requests

Clarify the reference: Which plant do you mean by the tall one?

Confirm the exclusion: You are not asking us to work on the magnolia.

Separate identification and permission: We have identified the plant, but pruning is not yet authorized.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Explaining a weather-related change

State the pause: The planned outdoor work is paused because of the site conditions after rain.

Preserve uncertainty: Crew availability has not been confirmed.

Request the update: I will request a scheduling update by Wednesday noon.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Reporting site observations without diagnosis

Name the observation: I saw standing water beside the east bed.

Acknowledge the concern: I understand why you are asking about a pipe.

Avoid a location inference: Being near zone 3 does not identify the faulty component.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Checking materials and requested quantities

State the order quantity: The job lists eight bags.

Name the requested material: The specified material is dark mulch.

Avoid a match claim: I cannot confirm that this matches the approved sample.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Responding to finish and cleanup concerns

Acknowledge the concern: I can see the clippings beside the front steps.

Avoid a denial: I will not describe the area as fully cleared.

Separate the rear area: The rear patio is outside this booking.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Handing over unfinished grounds work

Open with the completed item: The front-path leaves are cleared.

State what was not done: No planting or diagnosis was carried out there.

Name the owner: Ava owns the scheduling follow-up.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

acceptance distinguish receipt from acceptance	51
access permission verify access permission	14
additional area identify an additional area	60
additional request record an additional request	5
adjacent land distinguish adjacent land	14
appearance goal clarify the appearance goal	23
appointment status confirm appointment status	69
approved sample compare the approved sample	50
assumption avoid an ownership assumption	15
authorized area confirm the authorized area	15
bag count verify the bag count	50
beyond the fence clarify beyond the fence	14
booked scope confirm the booked scope	5
botanical name read the full botanical name	24
boundary avoid deciding the boundary	14
boundary clarification seek boundary clarification	15
branch identify the branch	24
callback request a callback	68
callback deadline preserve the callback deadline	68
canopy describe the canopy	23
cleanup area identify the cleanup area	59
cleanup standard refer to the cleanup standard	60
clearance request define the clearance request	15
clippings report remaining clippings	59

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

closeout avoid premature closeout	69
color description check the color description	50
communication request pass a communication request	69
completed task identify the completed task	68
completion claim avoid an unsupported completion claim	6
completion date avoid an unsupported completion date	33
completion record update the completion record	69
completion status correct the completion status	60
confirmation status state the confirmation status	33
confirmed booking verify a confirmed booking	6
confirmed fault avoid claiming a confirmed fault	42
controller refer to the controller	41
correction request pass a correction request	60
corrective visit discuss a corrective visit	59
coverage avoid an unsupported coverage promise	51
crew brief the crew	6
crew availability confirm crew availability	32
cultivar confirm the cultivar name	24
customer complaint acknowledge a customer complaint	60
customer constraint record a customer constraint	33
customer preference record the customer preference	24
customer priority preserve the customer priority	69
cutting authorization confirm cutting authorization	24
dark mulch confirm the dark-mulch request	50

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

deadline pressure acknowledge deadline pressure	33
deferred review record a deferred review	68
delivered quantity record the delivered quantity	50
delivery record check the delivery record	51
description discrepancy report a description discrepancy	51
diagnosis distinguish observation from diagnosis	42
distribution uniformity assess distribution uniformity	42
drainage describe a drainage concern	41
east bed locate the east bed	41
entrance planting describe the entrance planting	23
entry request refer an entry request	14
event deadline relay the event deadline	32
excluded area explain the excluded area	59
excluded task explain the excluded task	5
fence alignment describe the fence alignment	15
finish concern record a finish concern	59
flower bed locate the left flower bed	23
foliage refer to the foliage	24
follow-up arrangement confirm a follow-up arrangement	60
follow-up contact arrange follow-up contact	69
front lawn identify the front lawn	5
front steps locate the front steps	59
ground condition review the ground condition	32
grounds lead consult the grounds lead	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

grounds maintenance	discuss grounds maintenance	5
growth habit	assess the growth habit	23
handover	give a clear handover	68
hedge shaping	request hedge shaping	5
included area	confirm the included area	59
included task	name the included tasks	5
incomplete task	identify the incomplete task	59
inspection request	pass an inspection request	42
irrigation	discuss the irrigation system	41
irrigation line	refer to an irrigation line	41
irrigation zone	identify irrigation zone 3	41
land strip	identify the land strip	14
lead decision	record the lead decision	69
leaf clearance	confirm path leaf clearance	5
leaf removal	confirm front-path leaf removal	68
leak	refer a possible leak concern	42
magnolia	distinguish the magnolia	23
material match	verify the material match	51
material specification	check the material specification	50
material takeoff	check the material takeoff	51
missed cleanup	acknowledge missed cleanup	59
mowing	confirm the mowing task	5
mulch	confirm the mulch specification	50
natural brown	record the natural-brown label	50

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

net area calculate the net area	51
observation record make an observation record	60
observation time include the observation time	42
office coordinator contact the office coordinator	33
office referral make an office referral	15
office review refer for office review	6
open action assign an open action	69
order reference include the order reference	51
outstanding check name the outstanding check	33
ownership claim qualify the ownership claim	14
ownership transfer confirm ownership transfer	69
path identify the path	5
pending item flag a pending item	68
pipework refer to the pipework	42
planned work identify the planned work	32
plant form describe the plant form	23
plant health assess plant health	24
plant identification confirm plant identification	23
planting distinguish planting from review	68
pooling describe observed pooling	41
precipitation rate compare precipitation rates	42
price estimate distinguish a price estimate	6
product label read the product label	50
property line request property-line clarification	14

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

proposed method	review the proposed method	24
provisional suggestion	label a provisional suggestion	33
pruning	refer a pruning request	23
pruning extent	clarify the pruning extent	24
qualified assessment	request a qualified assessment	24
qualified statement	retain a qualified statement	15
quantity discrepancy	report a quantity discrepancy	51
rainfall	refer to recent rainfall	32
rear bed	identify the rear bed	68
rear fence	identify the rear fence	14
rear hedge	identify the rear hedge	5
rear patio	distinguish the rear patio	59
reference point	use a reference point	24
remedial work	arrange remedial work	59
replacement request	discuss a replacement request	51
request handoff	complete a request handoff	6
requested quantity	compare the requested quantity	50
resolution	verify the resolution	60
resumption	confirm authorization for resumption	32
return time	avoid inventing a return time	60
return visit	discuss a return visit	32
review outcome	avoid inventing a review outcome	69
review owner	name the review owner	42
revised plan	await a revised plan	15

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

revised schedule confirm a revised schedule	33
rosemary identify the rosemary	23
runoff report visible runoff	41
saturation describe visible saturation	41
scheduling owner identify the scheduling owner	68
scheduling update request a scheduling update	32
scope boundary preserve the scope boundary	60
scope change seek approval for a scope change	6
scope extension request a scope extension	15
separate quotation request a separate quotation	6
service date confirm the service date	6
service interruption explain a service interruption	33
service recovery discuss service recovery	60
shortfall report a two-bag shortfall	50
site attendance distinguish site attendance from a callback	69
site conditions assess site conditions	32
site plan consult the site plan	15
site restriction respect the site restriction	15
site visit confirm the site visit	6
specimen plant identify the specimen plant	23
sprinkler head identify a sprinkler head	41
standing water report standing water	41
status summary provide a status summary	68
stem identify the stem	24

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

substitute material seek approval for substitute material	51
substitution approval confirm substitution approval	51
supplier query raise a supplier query	50
survey distinguish a survey from a visual guess	15
suspected cause distinguish a suspected cause	42
system check request a system check	42
task authorization confirm task authorization	6
tentative date state a tentative date	32
tidy up clarify what tidy up means	23
unbooked visit describe an unbooked visit	68
unconfirmed ownership report unconfirmed ownership	14
unperformed work identify unperformed work	69
update target specify the update target	33
valve identify a valve	41
visible condition report the visible condition	42
visible residue describe visible residue	59
waterlogged describe a waterlogged area	32
weather dependency explain a weather dependency	33
weather pause explain a weather pause	32
within the plan stay within the plan	14
work order check the work order	5
work status report the work status	33
work-plan limit confirm the work-plan limit	14
workmanship discuss a workmanship concern	60

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] US Bureau of Labor Statistics. Grounds Maintenance Workers.

[Open the original source](#)

Occupational context for landscape maintenance, grounds tasks, and supervised crew work. The scenarios are original fictional conversations, not work instructions. Checked 10 October 2026.

[2] Occupational Safety and Health Administration. Landscape and Horticultural Services: Hazards and Solutions.

[Open the original source](#)

Context for respecting site conditions, training, and task-specific safety boundaries. No tool-operation or chemical-application procedure is taught here. Checked 10 October 2026.

[3] University of Minnesota Extension. Pruning Trees and Shrubs.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for distinguishing plant identity, appearance goals, and qualified pruning decisions. Regional timing advice and cutting procedures are not reproduced as learner instructions. Checked 10 October 2026.

[4] US Environmental Protection Agency. WaterSense: Sprinkler Spruce-Up.

[Open the original source](#)

Terminology context for irrigation components and observed pooling that warrants review. The book does not diagnose a leak or direct system testing or repair. Checked 10 October 2026.

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